

A way that can be spoken Is not a lasting way. A name that can be named Is not a lasting name. Without a name: the beginning of Heaven and Earth. Having names: the mother of the ten thousand things. Therefore: Constantly without	The Tao you can tell is not the true Tao. The names you can name are not the true names. The nameless is the origin of heaven and earth. The named is the mother of the myriad things. Always desireless	THE TAO THAT CAN BE TOLD The true Tao escapes definition, Likewise, Tao is unburdened by Name. Heaven and Earth originated unburdened by Name, However, Name serves well to create All Things. Unburdened by desire, the essence of	The Tao is the unobstructed breath. The Tao holds the opposing forces of the eternal Tao. The Name* is the unobstructed breath. The Name holds the opposing forces of the eternal Name. Heaven and Earth were without names (consciousness) in the beginning. The names of the ten-thousand things (everything) arose through its mother. If you are eternally without deep-seated desires, then you perceive	The spirit one can talk about is not the eternal spirit, and what you can name is not the eternal name. Nameless-Tao is the beginning of the heavens and the Earth. If you name it-it is no more than Matter. Therefore: he who conceives of nature freely grasps this Spirit and he who strives for material things is left with only the shell.
desire, thereby observe the mystery. Constantly with desire, thereby observe the boundaries. Those which these two are produced by Are the same but named differently. The abstraction of calling them the same The abstraction upon abstraction— The gateway to a host of mysteries.	you see its very essence. Always desiring you see its outer edge. The source of these two is the same Yet they are differently named. They are called the mystery, Mystery upon mystery, The gateway to the essence of all.	Tao unfolds. With desire, its manifestations alone appear. The same source serves both essence and manifestation. While viewed differently, both are characterized by deep mystery. Deep mystery - wondrous mystery - A gateway to the very essence of existence.	its mystery. If you have deep-seated desires, then you perceive its outer form. These both (the essence and outer form) have the same origin but have different names. Oneness (the Source) is called the mystery. The mystery will always be mysterious. All people are at the door of this mysterious One. * The Name: The universe becoming conscious of itself through its human form.	Spirit and matter are both one in their origin, yet different in appearance. This unity is a mystery-truly the mystery of all mysteries, the gate to all spirituality.

Everyone in the world knows the being of beautiful to be beautiful. Thus is ugliness completed. Everyone knows the being of good to be good. Thus is evil completed. Therefore: Being and non-being give birth to each other. Difficulty and ease complete each other. Long and short form each other. High and low lean on each other. Notes and music harmonize each other.	To everyone in the world Beauty seems beautiful because there is ugliness. Goodness seems good because there is wickedness Thus having and not having beget one another. Difficult and easy complement each other. The long and the short give rise to each other. The high and the low support each other. The voice and the sound harmonize each other. Front and back follow one another.	RELATIVENESS Beauty becomes recognized as beauty, As its difference from ugliness is seen. Likewise, Goodness and love become recognized, As their difference from evil and hatred is felt. The Relationship of: - Being and non-being is known through life and growth. - Difficult and easy is known through achievement and completion. - Long and short is known through form and contrast. - High and low is known through relationship and position. - Sound and voice is known through amplitude and —	In Heaven below (the sacred body) everyone recognizes beauty as beauty when ugly-heartedness ends. Everyone recognizes virtue as virtue when lack of virtue ends. Being and not being, together they give life. Difficult and easy, together they complete. Long and short, together they compare. High and low, together they support. Tone and voice, together they harmonize.	Only when man recognizes beauty as such does ugliness become reality. Only when man recognizes goodness as such does evil become reality. Because: being and nothingness began as one. Weight and weightlessness cannot exist alone. Distance and brevity prove each other and so do height and depth. Tune and voice abound together and past and present flow into one.
and behind follow each other. Therefore, the sages reside in the function of "non-action" And practice the teaching of no words. The ten-thousand things work in many senses and are not dismissed. Create but do not possess. Act but do not presume. Achieve goals but do not dwell on them. It's only because one does not dwell on success That success therefore does not leave.	Thus the sage manages affairs without taking action And spreads his teaching without using words. The myriad things flourish where he is And he does not forsake them. The sage creates but he does not possess. He toils but expects no praise. He does his work but does not dwell on his achievements. It's because he does not dwell on them That his achievements lasts.	harmony. - Front and behind is known through position and sequence. Thus: Wu-Wei graces the affairs of the Sage - Teaching gracefully, Without words. Receiving all happening as natural, Without needing to judge or control. Giving life and animation to all experience Without needing to dominate. Accomplishing, Without expecting reward. In never assuming importance, When the Sage's work is complete, It remains, everlastingly.	each other. The sages stay without action in their activities. They practice silence in their teachings. Ten-thousand things (everything) arise and they do not refuse. They give life and do not hold onto it. They achieve and do not take credit. What is achieved continues on its own merit. The masters agree not to dwell on their achievements.	Therefore the Sage remains in serenity whatever happens and silently does his teaching. As matters proceed, the Sage is not irritated. He works but wants no possessions. He acts but does not linger at single things. He creates but does not hang on a single word and because he is not tied to It, he will never miss It.

Not to esteem the worthy Causes the people not to contend. Not to value goods that are hard to get Causes the people not to do any stealing. Not to see desirables Causes the people's minds not to be confused. Therefore, the governance of	Do not glorify the skilled And people won't wrangle. Do not treasure rarities And people won't steal. Don't flaunt objects of desire And people's hearts will not be disturbed. When the sage rules, He keeps people's minds blank and their stomachs	WU-WEI When neither the meritorious, worthy, gifted nor wise are exalted or rewarded, Fighting, quarreling and contention become unnecessary. When treasure, rare objects and belongings are not accumulated, valued and prized, The rewards of thievery cease to have meaning. When desirable things are not seen nor displayed, The hearts of people are not troubled, excited or confused. The Sage governs himself and leads others	Do not exalt one whose virtue, talent, power, and action exceeds others, so people will not compete. Do not prize difficult-to-obtain goods, so that people will not commit robbery. Do not display deep-seated desires, so that people's minds are untroubled. The sages' way of ruling is by: - freeing the mind,	Not to give preference to the high and mighty will deter the envy of the people in order. To demonstrate no desire will give them peace in their hearts.
the sages: Empties their minds Makes true their insides Weakens their determinations Strengthens their bones Always causing the people not to know Not to desire Causing the clever men not to dare to act! By doing without "doing" There is necessarily nothing not managed.	full. He weakens their ambitions but strengthens their bones. He keeps people free from knowledge and desires So the ones who do have knowledge are afraid to act. If he acts without taking action There is nothing that is not right.	by: - Encouraging the heart to be open and free from desire. - Providing sustenance for the stomach. - Calming the will to strive for the sake of striving. - Strengthening the body. Thus, keeping all, innocent and free of knowledge and desire, The Sage discourages the cunning from harmful action. Wu-Wei - Action unforced - Permitting all to just happen, by itself,	- reinforcing the soul, - making gentle their ambitions, - and strengthening their bones. It is a constant that when the mind is free, people are free of deep seated desires. The master knows this and does not presume to act! Act without action (wu wei), then all is in order.	Therefore, when the Sage governs, he frees his people of passionate wishes and offers serenity to their souls. The Sage weakens greedy curiosity and strengthens the backbone of the upright. So does he master true serenity in good government.

The Tao washes
away and drinks
them, possibly never
getting full.

An abyss... it seems
to be the ancestor of
the ten-thousand
things

Blunting their
sharpness

Tao is empty yet
when used, it is never
used up.

The unbounded
source of the myriad
things!

It blunts the sharp
edges.

Untangles the knots.

TAO IS EMPTY

Tho' Tao is empty -
its grace is
inexhaustible

A deep and
unfathomable source,

The ancestor of all
there is.

Through the Tao: -
Rough edges are
smoothed.

- Hard knots are

The Tao creates
union that is never
draining.

The Deep! It is like
the ten-thousand
things (everything)
of the Source.

It blunts sharpness.

It unravels knots.

It harmonizes the

The Spirit is free of
things yet
inexhaustible in its
impact. The Spirit is
like the creator of all
being. He dulls the
sharp meanness that
clarifies all confusion.

Loosening their
tangles

Harmonizing their
lights

Equating their dust

Deep... it seems as
though possibly
alive.

The child of
I-don't-know-who.

It shaped the
foremost among the
gods.

Dims the bright light.

Unites wordly dust.

Perfectly hidden, yet
ever present.

I do not know its
origin.

It seems to have
existed before the
creator himself.

untied.

- Glare of light is
softened.

- Busyness of life is
tempered.

Tho' hidden deeply -
it is ever present.

Its origin ? - A
mystery to me.

It just seems to have
been forever.

light and it becomes
one with the dust of
the Earth.

Deep! It is enduring.

I do not know who its
ruler is.

It came before the
creation of images.

He unifies in
kindness. He knows
the oneness of man
with all dust. The
Spirit is eternal. I
know not when it
began. It almost
seemed to have
preceded the Lord
Itself.

Heaven and Earth are not humane For the ten-thousand things are taken to be straw dogs. Sages are not humane For the hundred clans are taken to be straw dogs. The space between Heaven and Earth—	Heaven and earth are impartial. The myriad things have no lasting value for them. The sage, too, is impartial. The people have no lasting value for him. The space between heaven and earth is	NATURE Nature is impartial - While regarding All Things of the universe as sacred, Graces them with equality. Likewise, the Sage is impartial - While regarding all creatures as sacred, Graces them with equality. The universe - a moving bellows - Yin	Heaven and Earth do not have human sentiments. Ten-thousand things (everything) have the importance of a straw dog.* The sages are not sentimental, thus they act toward the hundred families (everyone) as if they are straw dogs. The space between Heaven and Earth is like the space inside of a flute! It is	Heaven and earth know no preference. They look upon all beings as upon wooden animals. The sage knows no preference. He looks upon people as if they were made of wood.
Its similarity to bellows and flutes? Empty but not exhausted. Use it and more and more is produced. With too many words and ideas is distress. This is not as good as staying in the middle.	like a bellows. Though empty, it does not collapse. Work it and it will always yield more. Waste your breath and your strength is soon gone. It is better to hold firm to the core.	and Yang always emptying - always full, Endlessly working - endlessly yielding forth. Understanding the nature of the universe by words and by intellect, Leads to exhaustion. Hold instead to that intuition which, Rising from the gut of mankind, Resembles original nature.	hollow, yet does not get exhausted. The more active it is, the more it produces. Too many words bring about exhaustion. It is better to hold your center. * Straw dog: A sacrificial straw sculpture in the shape of a dog that was carefully maintained until it was used and then it was discarded.	The space between heaven and earth is like an ocean of wind and the emptiness of which creation follows creation. Words cannot describe it. It must be perceived by one's inmost self.

The valley spirit un-dying Is called the mystic female. The opening of the mystic female Is	The valley spirit never dies. She's called a mystery, a woman. The mystery, the gate of a woman Is	SPIRIT OF THE VALLEY The spirit of the valley is Empty - Receptive - Eternal. She is Yin - The Primal Mother. At her door	The valley of the divine never dies so says the mysterious female. The mysterious female of the	The Spirit of the deep never dies.
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called the root of Heaven and Earth. It endlessly, ceaselessly seems to exist. Use it inattentively.	called the source of heaven and earth. Enduring forever, she does not cease. Drawn upon, she does not wear out.	- the root of heaven and earth, Which is continuous, without end. Taking it, using it, drawing upon it, It serves eternally - without fail.	gate speaks of Heaven and Earth's origin. Soft, silky, and barely visible, her divine center is inexhaustible.	It is the eternal mother: The gateway through which wind The ever-protecting roots of heaven and earth. It is eternal becoming, effortless creation.
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Heaven is long-lasting; the Earth is old. Heaven and Earth are placed By that which can last long and be old. Because they do not live for themselves Is the reason they can live long. Therefore, the	Heaven endures, earth lasts forever. How are they able to do so? They do not live for themselves so they live on. Thus the	SOFT ACTION The universe is everlasting. Not existing for itself, but giving life to all, It endures forever. Thus, the Sage - - Remaining behind	Heaven is eternal, the Earth is enduring. There is a reason why Heaven and Earth are eternal and enduring. It is because they do not live for themselves. Thus, they give	Heaven and earth endure forever. Why do Heaven and earth endure eternally? Because they live not for themselves But for eternity.
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sages Put their bodies behind And yet their bodies go forward. Are outside their bodies And yet their bodies exist. Do not consider this selflessness to be wrong For it is the reason they can complete their "selves."	sage stays at the back Yet finds himself at the front. Unconcerned about himself, he survives. Unconcerned about his goals, does he not attain them?	and in the background, Finds himself ahead and in the foreground. - Staying detached, Finds himself at one with all. - Being selfless, Attains fulfillment.	life everlasting. The sage puts their own life second, and their body first. They reject their self, and the body remains. Surely, there is no self-interest. Power and accomplishment are self-interest.	So does the Sage withdraw In order that his inner Self may advance. He loses his Self to preserve his self. Is it not that he fulfills his Being by giving up his being?
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The highest good is like unto water. Water is good at benefiting the ten-thousand things And does not contend. It dwells in the places the masses of people detest— For which reason a few compare [it] with the Tao. Dwellings are perfected by the	The highest good is like water. Water benefits the myriad things and does not contend. It flows to the low places that people disdain. Therefore it becomes like Tao. The value of a house is in its location. The value of a mind - in the clarity of	WATERCOURSE WAY The highest good of mankind, is like water - - Without competition, gives Life to All Things. - Flowing, it seeks and dwells in places rejected by mankind. Thus it approaches close to the Tao. Accordingly, the Sage - - In dwelling, Seeks closeness to the earth. - In heart, Seeks that	Supreme goodness follows the natural laws of the earth like water. This goodness benefits the ten-thousand things (everything), yet it does not struggle. It rejects the lowest place that people go. This is why nature can be compared with the Tao. The Earth is a good place to	Generosity is like the Waters. It is a balm to all beings and rejects none. It dwells in places shunned by the masses, and therefore close to the Spirit.
earth. The heart is perfected by depth. Giving is perfected by benevolence. Speaking is perfected by sincerity. Uprightness is perfected by governance. Function is perfected by ability. Change is perfected by time. Only because one does not contend Is the reason one is without reproach.	thought. The value of companionship - in kindness. The value of words - in truthfulness. The value of governing - in justice. The value of a doing a job - in effectiveness. The value of taking an action - in timeliness. If there's no contention, there is no blame.	which is profound. - In relationships, Seeks gentleness and kindness. - In speech, Seeks sincerity and truthfulness. - In government, Seeks justice, order and peace. - In business, Seeks ability and competence. - In movement and action, Seeks timeliness. The Sage - Remaining free from competition and contention,	live with its profound good heart. It is best to deal with others humanely. Sincere speech is best. A just government is best. Competent service to others is best. There is a proper timing for best actions. The masters do not compete, therefore they will be without fault.	Generosity seeks out in dwellings the humble, in thinking depth, in giving love, in speaking truth, in ruling justice, in work knowledge in all our deeds the proper time. Generosity does not reject and therefore will not be rejected.

Grasping and filling—these are not as good as one's own self.

Calculations and vigorousness—these cannot defend for long.

Gold and jewels that fill a

Fill a pot to overflowing

And you you'll wish you had stopped in time.

Hone a sword to the very sharpest

And it won't stay sharp for long.

Fill your halls with gemstones

EXCESS

Stop short of full,

Pour not to the brim.

Over-sharpen the sword,

And the edge will soon blunt.

Be surrounded with treasure,

And

It is better to stop than to hold and overfill a cup.

A blade hammered to a sharp edge does not long endure.

If you fill your house

The full decanter if carried will spill over, The knife in use will lose its edge. Treasures of gold and gems are difficult to protect.

hall—none can guard them.

The wealthy are high-ranking but arrogant.

Abandoning themselves is their downfall.

Achievement: Escape the body, withdraw [to]

The Way of Heaven.

And you won't be able to guard them.

Be proud with wealth and status

And you will cause your own fall.

Withdraw when your work is done.

This is the way of heaven.

lie ill at ease.

Claim title and honor and wealth,

And downfall will follow.

With mission accomplished - withdraw.

Such is in harmony with Tao.

with gold and jade, no one can guard this wealth, honor, and pride.

What follows is your downfall.

Withdraw when your work is done.

This is Heaven's Tao.

Wealth and rank when joined by arrogance will now perish. To fulfill one's tasks, to find acceptance and then to retire to loneliness, is the true spiritual way.

Filling and operating Life, embracing the One Can one be without departing [from it]? Focusing ch'i, bringing about softness Can one be like a newborn child? Washing away divisions, mystically perceiving Can one be flawless? Loving the kingdom, governing the people Can one do it without "doing" it? The Heavenly	Keeping your heart and your spirit together Can you maintain their unity? Controlling your breath and making it soft Can you become like a newborn child? Washing and cleansing your inner vision Can you make it perfectly clear? Tending the people and ruling the state Can you refrain from interfering? As the gates	CHARACTER OF TE Can you: Embrace oneness - Maintaining a unity of mind, body and spirit? Control the Ch'i - By concentration, cause it to be soft, as a little child? Clear and purify inner mystic vision - Spotless and without blur, creating perfection? Govern and lead - openly, honestly and simply The governed barely sensing your effect? Handle "life's-gate" experiences of birth and death - Maintaining	Hold and manage the soul of the body. Embrace the One (the Source) with the power of not-separation! Concentrate your chi (vital force) to attain the gentle power of a newborn infant! Cleanse and purify your deep (inner) perception so it can be without flaws! Cherish the people. Govern the country with the power of emptiness!	Who finds union of mind and heart will reach immortality. Who masters his passions and turns them to deeds of kindness, is greater than a King. Who cleanses and clears his soul becomes free of vice. Who governs in love and justice is a benefactor even in mere contemplation.
Door opens, closes Can one be receptive? Brightening, purifying the four intelligences Can one be without knowing? Give birth to them. Rear them. Giving birth [to them] but not possessing [them] Acting [with them] but not presuming [them] Excelling [with them] but not dominating [with them]—	of destiny open and close Can you play the role of the woman? A your mind probes and explores the whole universe Can you remain ignorant? To give life and to nourish, To make yet not possess, To toil yet expect no praise, To guide yet not dominate: This is called the secret virtue.	the receptive principle of Yin? Be open to All Things - with true understanding Remaining detached, taking no action, not interfering? Give birth and nourish All Things - Seeking neither to lay claim nor possess? Act and work - Seeking neither credit nor reward? Lead and assist - Seeking neither to master nor dominate? To do this is the primal virtue - The profound and mysterious Te.	caring for her young! Illuminate the purity of the four directions. Open up to the power of not doing* (wu wei)! It gives life from the Source. It gives life and does not possess. It acts and does not presume. It increases and does not rule. This speaks of the mysterious action of the soul.	He is fearless should even the heavens come down. Who has insight in the depths of Times, may have not knowledge, yet supreme wisdom. To work and conserve, to work without greed for possessions, To work and let others use the produce, To encourage and not dominate, That I call deep virtue.

Thirty spokes joining together at one hub of a wheel: Accepting its emptiness There is the use of the cart. Shaping clay in order to make a vessel: Accepting its emptiness There is the use of	Thirty spokes join together in a wheel's hub, It is the center hole that makes the wheel useful. We shape clay to fashion jugs; It is the hollowness within that makes a jug useful. We	THE EMPTY While thirty spokes are the substance of the cartwheel, The empty space within the hub and between the spokes permits the wheel to be useful While clay is the substance of the vessel, The empty space within permits	Thirty spokes unite one hub. Because of its emptiness, the wheel is useful. Mold the clay and make a vessel. Because of its emptiness, the	Thirty spikes run into one hub: yet in the emptiness of the wheel lies its essence. From clay a jar is formed: yet in its emptiness lies the essence of the container.
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the vessel. Chiseling doors and windows in order to make a room: Accepting its emptiness There is the use of the room. Therefore, having them is considered as being beneficial. Lacking them is considered as being useful.	cut doors and windows in a house wall; It is these empty spaces that make the house useful. Thus things are valuable because of what they have And they are useful because of what they lack.	the vessel to be useful. While doors and windows are cut as the substance of the wall, The empty space within these enclosures permits them to be useful. Thus: Form is generated by what IS. Usefulness lies in what IS NOT.	vessel is useful. Cut out windows and doors to build a room. Because of its emptiness, the room is useful. Benefits emerge. Emptiness makes it useful.	Rooms are made by cutting windows and doors into the walls, yet in its emptiness lies the essence of the room. The visual matter can be observed but it is the Invisible that constitutes its true being.
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The five colors make people's eyes blind. The five tones make people's ears deaf. The five flavors make people's mouths lose [their tasting ability]. Hurrying, rushing, hunting, and chasing Make people's minds issue	Too much color dazzles the eye. Too much noise deafens the ear. Too much flavor deadens the taste. Excessive hunting disturbs the	SENSUOUS OVERLOAD Altogether, the five colors - Confuse, overwhelm and blind the eye. Altogether, the five sounds - Confuse, overwhelm and deafen the ear. Altogether, the five flavors - Confuse, overwhelm and	The eyes can become blind to the five colors. The ears can become deaf to the five notes. The mouth can become dull to the five tastes. Too much hunting in a field	Fine colors blind eyes to true reality Fine Tones shut out the othersounds. Fine spices deaden the taste. Races and hunts disturb a gentlesoul.
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forth insanity. Goods that are hard to get cause people's doings to harm. Therefore, the sages Act by the insides, not by the eyes. Therefore, let go of that And take up this.	mind. Excessive wealth disquiets the heart. Therefore the sage trusts his instincts, not his eyes. He heeds the former, ignores the latter.	dull the taste. Compulsive activity or pursuit of possessions - Confuses, overwhelms and maddens the mind. Thus: The Sage rejects the sensuous environment, Being better guided by intuitive truth - His inner nature.	over excites the heart and mind. Precious goods hinder one's activities. The sages attend to their souls, not to what their eyes see. They discard the latter and take hold of the former.	Gems and gold seduce the heart. The Sage follows not the eyes but the soul, Not the senses but the essence.
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Favor and disgrace seem like a surprise. Value great suffering as you would [keeping] your own body. What is the meaning of "Favor and disgrace seem like a surprise"? Favor [eventually] declines. Getting it is like a surprise. Losing it is like a surprise. This is the meaning of "Favor and disgrace seem like a surprise." What is the meaning of	Praise and condemnation both cause dismay. Honor and great pain are bound up together. Why do praise and condemnation both cause dismay? Praise makes us low. We're dismayed when we get it. And we're dismayed when it's taken away. That's why praise and condemnation both cause dismay. Why are honor and great pain bound up	NATURE OF FEAR Favor and glory as well as disfavor and disgrace, All cause pain in equal measure. - As disfavor and disgrace cause pain, Possessing favor and glory - The fear of its loss is ever present. What we value and what we choose to fear Are both contained	Take on shame, fear, and disappointment with trepidation. Take on your great misfortune with your body. Why talk about shame, fear, and disappointment? Favor acting from below. Gain, it comes with fear. Loss, it comes with fear. This tells you about taking on shame, fear, and disappointment. Why talk about your body taking on your great misfortune?	Forgiveness is to be shunned like a disgrace. Ambition for honors is a burden like the body. Forgiveness denigrates; one lives in hope to obtain, in fear of losing it. Ambition for honors is a burden like the body.
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[keeping] you own body"? Our place, according to those who have great suffering, Is our having a body. When we lack bodies What suffering do we have? Therefore, value the "self" that's considered as being the world As though you are able to be entrusted with the world. Love the "self" that's considered as being the world	together? I'm bound to be in pain because I care about myself. If I did not care about myself, what pain could I suffer? If you respect the world as you respect yourself You're ready to tend the world. If you care about the world as you care about yourself You're ready to rule the world.	within our body/selves. We possess fear because we have a body/self. Ceasing to acknowledge the body part of self, Nothing of significance remains to be feared. The leader - In honoring and loving his responsibilities as he honors and loves the body/self, Can be entrusted with the leadership of his domain.	the great misfortune, you are in a position for your body to emerge through reaching a state of not-self (emptiness). You emerge. This is why misfortune is reason to honor your body. The action of Heaven below (the sacred body) can be trusted. Heaven below expresses humanity through its actions The action of Heaven below can be entrusted to Heaven below.	The body is burdensome. If I had no body I would be burdenfree. Who honors the community as himself is worthy of her. Who loves the community as himself makes her his own.
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Inspect it and you will not see it. Its name is said to be "The Obscure." Listen for it and you will not hear it. Its name is said to be "Becoming Silent." Roll it around in your hands and you will not obtain it. Its name is said to be "The Subtle." Those who are not able to achieve these three ask— This is the reason they are blended and handled as one: At its ascending, not bright. At	Look! It cannot be seen; It's called the obscure. Listen! It cannot be heard; It's called the soundless. Feel it! It cannot be grasped: It's called the bodiless. These three defy scrutiny. Intermingled, they blend into one. Above it is not bright. Below it is not dark. Continuous, Unceasing, Unnamable,	THE MYSTICAL TAO Looking for it, it cannot be seen - Being formless, it is called Yi, the invisible. Listening to it, it cannot be heard - Being soundless, it is called Hsi, the inaudible. Grasping at it, it cannot be reached - Being subtle, it is called Wei, the intangible. These three; imperceptible, indescribable - Mystically united and elusively perceived as an undefinable oneness. As the oneness ascends - no light	Look for it and you will not see it; its name is called invisible. Listen for it and it cannot be heard; its name is called soundless. Try to touch it and you will not be able to grasp it; its name is called formless. It will do you no good to scrutinize these three. They merge and become one. Those above are not light. Those below are not dark. An unbroken thread.	We search for it yet see it not; it is the invisible. We listen for it, yet hear it not; it is the untouchable. Its trinity is inseparable. We recognize it only as one, innerbound. Its distance is incomprehensible, its depth can not be fathomed. Eternally creative, it can not be defined.
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its descending, not dark. The measure of measure, it cannot be named. Repeatedly returning to "no-thing-ness" It is called "The Form of No-Form" "The Shape of No-thing-ness." It is called "The Indistinct" "The Unclear" Greet it and you will not see its face. Follow it and you will not see its back. Hold to the Tao of the Ancients In order to tame the existence of present times. One can know the ancient beginning. It is called the "Tao Epoch."	occurrence of no occurrence. It is a form that takes no form. Elusive like a shadow. Intangible like haze. Confront it! It has no face. Follow it! It has no back. If you grasp the ancient Tao You can rule the realm of today. If you know the ancient beginnings You know the essence of Tao.	appears. As the oneness descends - no darkness is perceived. Unceasingly, continually, form eluding definition, Evasively reverting to spirit - to nothingness. The form of formlessness. The image of imagelessness. The oneness remains nameless. Meeting it, it has no part which is front. Following it, it has no behind. Encompassing the ancient Tao, Present affairs are mastered. Knowing the primal nature of mankind and the universe,	An unbroken thread that cannot be named. It again returns to the original state. It is a shape without a shape. It is an image without substance. This is called illusory and inexplicable. Go toward it and you do not see its face. Follow it and you do not see its back. Retain the ancient ways of the Tao in order to take hold of the present. You have the power to know the Source. This is called the Tao's unbroken thread.	It goes back to Nothingness. It can be called: The incomprehensible Mysterious. You walk towards it and find not even its Beginning. You follow it and there is no End. Who understands the Spirit of the old Sages masters his own time, and thru them the very root of all time. Such is the continuum of the Spirit.
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Those of old who were good at being warriors

Were subtly, wonderfully, mystically in communication

With profundities that can't be fathomed.

Precisely because [the ancient warriors] can't be fathomed

Is the reason one is forced to take them by appearances:

Cautious... as if in winter, crossing a stream

Strategizing... as if they feared their own four neighbors.

Dignified... they seemed forgiving.

Scattered... like ice floes about to break apart.

Honest... they seemed plain and simple.

The ancient followers of Tao were shrewd and discerning.

Their knowledge was arcane, beyond comprehension.

There are no words that describe them well.

Cautious, as if fording a frozen river.

Watchful, as if dreading foes on all sides.

Courteous, like a guest.

Yielding, like ice on the thaw.

Simple, like uncut wood.

ANCIENT MASTERS

The ancient masters and rulers,

So subtle and mysterious,

profound and penetrating,

Too deep to directly comprehend -

May be known by their appearance,

Cautious - As if crossing a frozen stream.

Watchful - As if fearing danger all around.

Courteous - As if a visiting guest.

The masters* of ancient times could penetrate subtle mysteries too intense to be comprehended.

Students** of the Tao are truly not able to understand and feel compelled to describe these mysterious qualities.

Be hesitant, like crossing a river in winter.

Watchful! Like standing in awe of all four directions.

Reserved! And behave like a guest.

Yielding! Like melting ice.

Genuine! Like the natural state of uncarved wood or uncut jade.

Empty! Like a valley.

The great sages of antiquity were wise and intuitive. It is difficult to comprehend their depth. They were cautious like men who are crossing an ice covered river, Cautious like people wary of certain neighbors. Reserved as only guests are. Relenting like melting ice, plain as uncut timber, open like a valley. Dark as deep water.

they seemed [as open] as a valley.

[Apparently] acting without a plan... they seemed muddled.

Calm... they seemed like the ocean.

Like wind in the mountains... they seemed to be without stagnation.

Who can, in muddiness, use the gradual purification of stillness?

Who can, in serenity, use the gradual arising of movement?

They who hold to this Tao do not desire to overflow.

It's only by not overflowing That one can therefore be shielded

And newly made.

Wide open, like a valley.

Obscure, like murky water.

Who can keep murky water still and cause it to clear?

Who can make what's inert active and bring it to life?

Those who follow Tao have no wish to become full.

Thus they can wear out with no need to be renewed.

melt.

Genuine - As if a piece of uncarved wood.

Receptive - As if an open valley.

Opaque - As if in muddy waters.

Waiting quietly while the mud settles,

Remaining still until the moment for action,

They, who embrace this Tao,

Obtaining just that which is sufficient,

All needs are satisfied.

Thus they long endure.

Turbulence! Like churning waters.

Who can be still and slowly calm the churning waters?

Who can be tranquil with this motion to insure the gradual birth?

The Tao is not depleted by deep-seated desires.

Separation from deep-seated desires is not new.

It completes.

* person who knows all from 1 to 10 (1 indicates Heaven, and 10 indicates being centered in the four directions)

** upstanding community member who is trying to do things correctly.

Who can as they interpret the turbulent thru serenity? Who can as they thru their own lives revive the dead souls? Who is filled with serene thoughts desires no other fulfillment, Who desires no other fulfillment is not attacked by novelties of the day. Such man can be of simple status yet reach perfection.

Bring about emptiness to the extreme. Guard true stillness. The ten-thousand things rise together. I therefore observe their return: Those ten-thousand plants—each plant—returns Going back to its root. Going back to the root is said to be stillness. This is called returning to life. Returning to life is called	Empty yourself to the utmost. Remain perfectly calm. The myriad things arise together I watch their return. They flourish, then each goes back to its root. To go back to the root is to find tranquility. To find tranquility is to come back to life. Coming back to life is what is constant. To know what is constant is to be enlightened.	THE CYCLE OF ALL THINGS Let the mind be empty of preconceptions and distraction - Permit a meditative quietness to prevail. Observe the cycle of All Things - Their birth and rise to activity, A flourishing, And ultimate return to their generative roots. Quietness, repose and tranquility characterize the return to the roots of creation. Knowing it as the destiny of All Things - An unchanging cycle, An eternal law of	Attain the highest emptiness. Keep a constant stillness. Ten-thousand things (everything) come into being and flourish in unison. I witness the return. Now all things can flourish, flourish. Every one is restored and returns to the origin. The return to the origin is known as stillness. This is called a return to life. Repeating life is known as eternal.	Who ascends the peak of Emptiness Will reach serenity. All Beings do I see arise and then return whence they came. To return to one's origin means to acquiesce. To acquiesce means to have fulfilled one's destiny. To fulfill one's destiny means to have comprehended eternity. To comprehend eternity means to be enlightened.
the Constant. Understanding the Constant is called clarity. Not understanding the Constant: Reckless actions—misfortune. Understanding the Constant, forgive. Forgive, then be unbiased. Be unbiased, then be whole. Be whole, then be Heaven. Be Heaven, then be Tao. Be Tao, then be eternal. Not having a body, there is no danger.	Not to know what is constant is to court disaster. When you know what is constant you embrace everything. When you embrace everything you are just. When you are just you are kingly. When you are kingly you follow nature. Following nature you follow Tao. Following Tao you last through all time. Till the end of life, you will suffer no harm.	nature - Is to be enlightened. To know it not, is to court misfortune. Knowing the eternal law is to be all embracing. All embracing is to be impartial. Impartial is to be noble. Being noble is to be one with nature. Being one with nature is to be in accord with the Tao. Being in accord with the Tao - Essence is everlasting. Tho' body/self demise, the self is eternal.	eternal speaks of the light. Not perceiving the eternal is an error that brings calamity. Experience of the eternal is all-embracing. The all-embracing opens and reveals. The act of revealing connects Heaven, Humanity and Earth. The act of connecting Heaven, Humanity and Earth is heaven. Heaven is the Tao. The Tao is enduring. Till the end, the body is not in peril.	Not to comprehend eternity means to be subject of passions, and that is evil. Comprehending eternity makes one magnanimous. Magnanimity makes one just. To be just is Kingly. The Kingly is Heavenly. The Heavenly is the Spiritual. The Spirit is Immortal. And thus the ephemerality of the body can not harm us.

The highest superiors— People below them [merely] know they have them. The next highest—people below them love and praise them. The next highest—people below them fear them. The next highest—people below them insult them. Where	Of the best leaders people barely know they exist. Next come the ones people love and praise. Then the ones they fear. Then the ones they disdain. Those who	GREAT LEADER The greatest leader is barely known to exist. Next is one who is loved and acclaimed. Then one who is feared. Finally one who is despised. The great leaders, Having faith and confidence in others, Receive	The superior person who is below* perceives reality. The next best person loves and praises them. The next best person is in fear of them. The next best person despises them. Good intentions are not adequate in that place of reality. People are reluctant to not have good intentions! They have words. They reward	When a ruler is truly great the people hardly notice his existence. Some of their successors were admired, some were feared, some were despised. Rulers without faith in the people lost the people's confidence.
trust is insufficient There is distrust. So gentle, [the sage] values their words. [And so when] their achievements are completed And their work is successful The hundred clans all proclaim "We are naturally like this!"	don't trust receive no trust. The best leader is sparing in his use of words. When his task is accomplished, when his work done. Everyone says: "We did it ourselves."	faith and confidence in return. In a quiet and calm manner, with few words, See the task accomplished, See the work complete. A measure of great leadership - When all feel the task was completed of its own accord.	accomplishment True success is achieved when the hundred families (all people) say it is as though we all did it together. * The concept that if you place yourself below everything then you will be able to receive everything and accurately perceive your world; e.g., the ocean lies below the rivers to receive them.	The great rulers did not aggrandize themselves, They performed their tasks and the people felt: We are among ourselves.

When the great Tao is abandoned

There exists humaneness and righteousness.

When intelligence and wit go forth

There exists greatness and deception.

When the six

When Tao is forgotten

There is kindness and justice.

When cleverness and learning arise

There is great duplicity.

When conflict

FORGOTTEN TAO

When the natural Tao is forgotten,

- Doctrines of humanity and codes of justice arise.

- Knowledge and wisdom appear with artifice

and hypocrisy close behind.

When the great Tao is abandoned,

Humanity with righteousness is the practice.

After that, intellect and knowledge appear.

Then comes great hypocrisy.

The six relationships (the entire family)

Where the great Spirit is in decline, there is much talk of love and liberty. Where the great Spirit is in decline, there is much talk of prudence and equality.

familial relationships are not in harmony

There exists obedience and charity.

When kingdoms and households are in darkness and chaos

There exists loyalty and subjugation.

breaks out in the house

There are loving parents and children.

When the country falls into chaos

There are loyal ministers.

- Harmony departs from family relationships, and deeds of filial piety and devoted

parenthood replace natural instincts.

- Civil disorder prevails and loyal politicians

become models of dutiful behavior.

will not be in harmony.

After that, duty and devotion to the state arise.

Families will be in trouble and there will be disorder.

After that, loyal ministers appear.

Where peace is absent in the family, there is much talk of family devotion. When suppression darkens the lands, everywhere there is talk of loyalty and obedience.

Get rid of sagacity, abandon wisdom: The people benefit a hundred-fold. Get rid of humanitarianism, abandon righteousness: The people recover filial piety and motherly love. Get rid of cleverness, abandon profit: Robbers and thieves	Give up being great, forget being clever And people will benefit enormously. Give up being kind, forget being just And love will return to the family. Give up being sly, forget being greedy And there'll	SIMPLICITY Discard and abandon formalized wisdom and knowledge, And hundredfold benefits accrue. Discard and abandon conventionalized righteousness, duty and morality, And be graced with natural harmony. Discard and abandon cunning	Renounce holiness, discard certainty, the people will benefit one-hundred fold. Abandon benevolence with righteousness, people will return to devotion in the family. Abandon craftiness, discard profit, and thieves and bandits will not appear. Don't be content	Pretend not to saintliness, nor to smartness and the people will prosper!Talk not of Humanity nor of absolute Justice and the people will returnto family devotion.
do not exist. Those who [understand] these three things Therefore take [mere] civility to be insufficient. Therefore, this directive has a place it belongs to: See the plain. Embrace simplicity. Diminish selfishness. Desire little.	be no more thefts or robberies. Yet as a lesson These three are incomplete. The essential part to be added is this: Become plain and simple Like uncut wood. Restrain your ambitions, Restrict your desires.	skills - legalized profiteering, And robbery as well as deception disappear These three, of themselves insufficient - Consider then, - Original simplicity. - Unadorned nature. - Selflessness. - Limited desire.	to use these three lessons as decorations. Learn to depend on them. Recognize simplicity, embrace the purity of uncarved wood or uncut jade. Reduce self-interest, diminish desires, abandon learnedness, and the people will have no sorrow.	Give up the great profits as well as your Luxuriesand there will be fewer thieves and robbers. In all these things the pretenseis harmful. Therefore one must retain the lasting virtues: To retain Simplegoodness, humility and moderation.

Get rid of erudition; do not fret.

The saying of "yes" or "indubitably"—

They are removed from each other by how much?

In what way?

The imparting of "good" or "evil"—

In what way do they seem to differ from each other?

But that which the people fear

Is not suited to be disrespected.

Wild indeed, those not yet centered!

The masses of people are boisterous and exuberant

As if enjoying the greatest sacrificial feast.

As if in Spring, climbing onto the lookouts.

I alone am tranquil and quiet indeed, not yet showing these signs—

Give up studying and you
will have no distress.

Is there a difference
between "yes" and "no"?

The good and the evil -
are they alike?

Ought I to fear what
others fear?

Confusion reigns; it is
without end.

All around, people make
merry

As if holding a festival in
spring,

As if about to gorge at a
feast.

I alone remain still and
reveal nothing

Like an infant yet unable
to smile.

I am forlorn, with no
place to go.

POOR ME ?

End the study of
pretentiousness and surface
formality,

And much sorrow, trouble
and nuisance will cease.

The distinctions between yes
and no, good and evil,

Between what people fear
and fail to fear:

- Are often semantic.
- Are often contradictory.
- Are often false.
- Are often superficial.

While many may be content -
Partaking of party and feast,

Viewing the land from a-high
in the springtime,

I alone am inert, without
animation,

Like an infant who has yet to
learn to smile.

Alas !

Abandon learnedness, and
you will not walk slowly with
a troubled head and heart.

I join together certainty with
uncertainty so both can be
discarded and come close to
what is.

I join together the virtuous
with the loathsome so both
can be discarded and become
what is.

People are afraid. They are
unable to not be afraid.

Without restraint! They are
without limits!

All people are busy, busy.

Like taking part in a great ox
feast.

Like in spring climbing a
terrace.

I alone remain calm!

I am one who gives no sign,
like a newborn baby
who does not —
smi —
I —

Like an infant babying those
who are not yet children.

Weary, weary, as if no place
to belong to!

The masses of people all
have surplus

And I alone seem to be
missing something.

Mine is the heart of a fool,
besides!

Turbid and chaotic indeed,
the ordinary people, bright
and eminent!

I alone am muddled and
confused.

Ordinary people study,
survey, and scrutinize.

I alone am bored and
uninterested.

The masses of people all
have instrumentality

But I alone am both ignorant
and lowly.

I alone differ from people

And value the nourishing
Mother.

spare,
I alone seem to have
nothing.
I seem like a fool; I'm
utterly confused.
Other people are bright;
so bright.
I alone am dark; so dark.
Other people are smart; so
smart,
I alone am dull; so dull.
Ever drifting like the
restless ocean,
Blown about like the
ceaseless storm.
Other people pursue their
goals,
I alone seem foolish and
aimless.
Only I am a stranger; I'm
unlike the others.
I take nourishment only
from the mother.

I am alone, with nowhere to go.

While others appear to have abundant possessions and grace,

I alone appear to have nothing.

I feel inferior, foolish and left out.

While others are clear, bright and confident,

I alone feel muddled, dull and confused.

While others look lively, penetrating and self assured,

I alone feel depressed, aimlessly adrift in sea

Blown by the winds on an ever changing course

While others seemingly have a purpose,

I alone feel awkward.

Wherein am I so different?

I alone value drawing my sustenance from the

O my foolish heart: I
am confused. They
appear unperturbed, I
alone step in the dark.
They appear
exuberant, I alone am
sad, sad as the sea.
Torn apart like a
vagrant. They are
imbued with
usefulness, Only I am
clumsy like a peasant,
I am different from
them, Yet I am on my
knees before Creative
Nature.

The forming of exceeding virtue— Only the Tao indeed manages [to do]. The functioning "substance" of the Tao is only indistinct, only vague. So vague! So indistinct! Within it exists shape. So indistinct! So vague! Within it exists the physical world. So obscure! So profound!	It is the mark of great virtue to follow Tao alone. What can one say of Tao? It is elusive; it's like a shadow, It is intangible; it is like haze. Elusive like a shadow, yet it holds ideas within. Intangible like haze, yet	ESSENCE OF TAO From Tao alone, follows Te, The absolute manifestation of virtue. The Tao, tho' so evasive, elusive, intangible - Subtly within it, deep and obscure, - Appear images, forms, entities. - Appear the mystical essence.	The all-embracing action of the soul displays itself the same as the Tao to be followed. The Tao acts on things entirely elusively and inexplicably. Inexplicable! Elusive! Its center has form. Inexplicable! Elusive! Its center has substance. Deep! Mysterious!	True Virtue is born of Reason, The essence of reason is unfathomable and incomprehensible. The faces of reason can not be discerned, The world that appears in reason, no one knows how, Impenetrable is the darkness where the heart of Being dwells, This being is Truth itself and Faith itself. From eternity to eternity, they will never perish.
Within it exists essence. Its essence is exceedingly real— Within it exists the evidence [for this]. From ancient times even unto the present day Its name has not departed. Thereby inspect the many beginnings. How do I thereby know the form of the many beginnings? With this.	it holds entities within. Mysterious and dim, yet it holds spirit within. Throughout all time Its name has been retained. Thus we can view the origin of all things. How do I know the origin of all things? I do because of what's within me.	The essence - so subtle, yet so real. From the beginning of time it mysteriously manifests itself, Providing a fleeting sense of primal power. How else may Te be known but through this essence of the Tao ?	Its center contains the life force. Its life force is very genuine, it can be tested. Throughout the ages its presence has never ceased. Witness all things of creation. How I know all things of creation is through this.	Who saw the beginning of All. The beginning All, one knows only thru the perennial Spirit.

Crookedness follows perfection. Bending follows straightness. Emptiness follows fullness. Brokenness follows newness. Lack follows gain. Excess follows confusion. Therefore, the sages embrace the One Becoming examples for the world: They do not show themselves, and so are radiant. Do not affirm themselves, and so are made known.	Be broken and you'll become whole. Be fallen and you will stand tall. Be empty and you will fill up. Be worn and you'll become new. Have little and you will gain. Have much and you'll be confused. Therefore the sage clings to the One And serves as a guide for the world. He does not flaunt himself, so he shines bright. He	YIELDING The yielding bend but do not break, Overcoming all, they are preserved whole. Being bent, permits straightening. Being empty and hollow, permits filling. Being torn, tattered and depleted, permits renewal. Having little, permits gain and possession. Having much, permits confusion. Therefore the Sage embraces unity. Holding fast to the absolute oneness, Manifests this as an example to the world. Not flaunting himself,	Yield to be whole. Curl in order to straighten. Empty in order to be filled. Grow old in order to be renewed. Reduce in order to receive. Excess creates confusion. The sage embraces unity to become Heaven below's (the sacred body's) example. They do not display themselves, which allows them to shine. They —	What is half will become perfect. What is crooked will become straight. What is empty will be filled. What is old will be rejuvenated. Who has little, will receive in plenty. Who has much, will be deprived. The Sage embraces the All and becomes the Idol of the World. He does not look out for himself, and thus he glories.
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not brag about themselves, and so have merit. Do not throw their weight around, and so are leaders. Precisely because they do not contend Is the reason the world cannot contend with them. That which is said of old: "That which is crooked follows perfection"— How can it be an empty saying? Truly perfect and return to it.	does not insist on being right, so he is renowned. He does not brag, so he succeeds. He does not boast, so he lasts long. He contends with no one, So no one can contend with him. The ancients used to say: "Be broken and you'll become whole." Are these but hollow words? If you are truly whole everything will come to you.	He becomes luminous to all. Not bestowing himself with self-importance, He becomes both prominent and illustrious. Not boasting of himself, He receives both recognition and credit. Disdaining pride, His works endure. Not striving to contend nor compete, He attracts no contention - no competition Thus, the Sage confirms - To yield is to overcome, to preserve whole. To yield is to gain All Things.	do not see themselves as being right, which allows them to be outstanding. They do not show off, which allows them to be rewarded. They are not arrogant, which allows them to endure. It is precisely because the masters do not resist Heaven below that no one is able to contest them. The ancients said yield to be whole. How can these words possibly be hollow?	He does not please himself, and thus the world possesses him. He does not flaunt his accomplishments, and thus the world venerates him. He strives not to be on top, thus he will be elevated. He does not attack, and the world around him is still. Truly: Everything flows freely into the seeker of perfection.
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Sparse speech is by nature. Therefore, whirling winds do not last the morning. Sudden rain does not last the day. Who are they who do this? Heaven and Earth. Even Heaven and Earth are not able to [make it] last— And [what are] people Compared to [them]? Therefore, those who manage affairs with the Tao Are together with	Nature is sparing of words: High winds do not last all morning. A cloudburst does not last all day. What makes them happen? Heaven and earth. If heaven and earth cannot sustain their works How can people sustain theirs? Therefore if you follow Tao you become like Tao. If	ADMONITIONS Nature is inaudible, yet it speaks distinctly - A fierce storm lasts less than a morning, Rain normally less than a day. These, being of nature and short in duration, Thus should the duration of violence in man be no greater than these. Hence: One who follows Tao, becomes one with Tao.	Scatter your words spontaneously. Gusty winds do not outlast the dawn. Torrential rains do not outlast the sun. Why does Heaven Earth (nature) do this? Heaven Earth (nature) honors the power of change. Is it less so for people? You need to pursue your activities through the Tao. The Tao becomes one with the Tao.	To speak sparingly is the natural course. A whirlwind lasts not throughout the morning. A spray rain lasts not the day. Such it is between heaven and earth. And such it is with man. Who dedicates himself to reason will become one with reason. Who dedicates himself to virtue, will become one with virtue.
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the Tao. Those who are virtuous are together with Virtue. Those who err are together with error. Those who are with the Tao—the Tao is likewise glad to gain them. Those who are with Virtue—Virtue is likewise glad to gain them. Those who are with error— Error—alas!—is glad to gain them. Where belief is insufficient	you follow virtue you become like virtue. If you forsake Tao you become forsaken. Those who are like Tao Are gladly welcomed by Tao. Those who are like virtue Are gladly welcomed by virtue. Those who are forsaken Are gladly welcomed by forsakenness. Those who don't trust receive no trust.	with Te. One who separates from Tao and Te, becomes one with separation. And: When one adheres to Tao, Tao adheres to him When one adheres to Te, Te adheres to him. When one adheres to separation, Separation adheres to him. Separating from faith in one's own nature,	of the soul. Change becomes one with change. Become one with the Tao and enjoy the benefits of the Tao. Become one with the action of the soul and enjoy the benefits of the action of the soul. Become one with change and enjoy all the benefits of change. Faith is never enough! Be in the place of change, not in the place of faith.	Who gives to evil will become one with evil. Who is one with reason, will be embraced by reason. Who is one with virtue, will be embraced by virtue. Who joins evil will be one with evil. Who has no faith, will never inspire faith.
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Those on tiptoe do not stand. Those who straddle do not walk. Those who show themselves do not shine. Those who affirm themselves are not made known. Those who brag about themselves are without merit. Those	Those who stand on tiptoe do not stand firm. Those who walk in long strides do not walk well. Those who flaunt themselves do not shine bright. Those who insist on being right are not	THE IMPERFECT Standing on "tip toe", one stands not firmly. Straining in stride, one cannot walk far. Flaunting of deeds, one is unfavorably noticed. Being self-righteous, one is not respected. Boasting of self, one's merit is unrecognized.	On tiptoes, they cannot be steady. When they straddle something, they cannot go forward. Self-display is not the light. Self-righteousness is not outstanding. Boasting about yourself is not of service. Praising yourself cannot endure.	No one can stand solid when on his toes. No one can run with spreadlegs. Who admires himself will not be venerated. Who is pleased with oneself, the world will not praise.
who throw their weight around are not leaders. Those who are with the Tao also say: "Surplus food, useless forms—Nature perhaps detests them." Therefore, those who have the Tao do not reside [in such things].	renowned. Those who brag do not succeed. Those who boast do not last long. To the follower of Tao they're loathsome. They're like leftover food or pointless pursuits. The person of Tao turns away from them.	Glorifying of self, one loses the opportunity for greatness. From the viewpoint of Tao These represent imperfect Te, Valued as are filth or disease. Thus: Those who value the Tao may permit themselves to avoid these things.	From the point of view of the Tao this is called excessive consumption and redundant actions. All beings will detest this. One who follows the Tao does not dwell in excessive consumption and redundant actions.	Who praises himself, merits little appreciation. Who pushes for the top, will not be elevated. For the Spirit he is a leftover, an odd growth on the body. The people will look upon him in disdain, And those who live by reason will not emulate his like.

There was a thing disordered but complete Before Heaven and Earth were born. Tranquil... empty... alone standing unchanging. Swirling and not tiring. It can be considered as being to the world a mother. I do not know its name. Forced to verbalize it, I call it "Tao." Forced to describe it, I call it "Great." Great, it is said to leave. Leaving, it is said	There is something, complete and embracing all, Born before heaven and earth took form, Soundless and void, Standing alone, unchanging, Moving ahead, unceasing. It seems to be the mother of the universe. I do not know its name so I call it Tao. Compelled to give it a name, I would call it Great. Being great, it reaches far. Reaching far, it	OF HUMANITY, HEAVEN, EARTH AND TAO Being formless, yet mysteriously complete: - Existing for all time. - Silent without substance. - Standing alone, changing not. - Pervading all and unfailing. - Regarded as the Mother of all there is. Not having a name, I call it the Tao. If needing to identify its nature by granting it a name, Call it "The Great". Being great it flows, extending itself endlessly. Thus flowing, it is called far-reaching.	The substance that arose from the chaos is whole. Before Heaven and Earth were born there was stillness! Formlessness! Alone, poised, not yet changed. Then it went out everywhere unhindered. It then became Heaven below's (the sacred body's) mother. We still know it by the name of the one. The philosopher, they speak of the Tao. Forced to create a name, I name it the great.	There is a Being of Perfection, incomprehensible. It ever was, stilland formless, before they came, stars and earth. Unchangeable and alone,unencumbered, whirling thru Time. I name it, Creative Nature. It has noname, shall I call it Tao, the Spirit? Or the substance, the infinite?The infinite in unlimited attributes? The great Distant, that forever returns!Tao is great, the Heavens are great.
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to be distant. Distant, it is said to return. Therefore, the Tao is great. Heaven is great. The Earth is great. Humankind is also great. In the middle realm, there are four greatnesses And humankind then dwells in this Completeness: Humankind is ruled by the Earth The Earth is ruled by Heaven Heaven is ruled by the Tao The Tao is ruled by its own nature.	flows everywhere. Flowing everywhere, it returns to its source. Indeed, Tao is great. Heaven is great. Earth is great. Mankind is great, too. These four are great in the universe And mankind is one of them. Mankind follows the rules of the earth. The earth follows the rules of heaven. Heaven follows the rules of Tao. Tao follows its own rules, too.	started. Accordingly, Just as Tao is great - the ultimate essence, So, heaven is great - the creative essence, Clear and pure. Earth is great - the receptive essence, Massive and stable. Humanity is great - the harmonious essence, Intelligent and sensitive. Note then, that humanity is one of the four great essences. While humanity is conditioned by earthly essence, And earth is conditioned by heavenly essence, And heaven is conditioned by the essence of Tao, The Tao, conforms to its own nature.	Far reaching, it is known to go far away. Far away, it is known to return. Thus the Tao is great, Heaven is great, Earth is great, the nobility of humanity is great. Within the universe there exist four great directions and the nobility of humanity dwells there in the unity of the one. Humanity emulates the Earth, the Earth emulates the Heavens, the Heavens emulate the Tao, and the Tao emulates itself.	The Universe is great. May the rulerbe in tune with the Spirit. Four things are great in the world, May theruler be one of them. Man is under the law of the earth, the earth underthe law of the Universe, The universe under the law of Tao and Tao is theLaw itself.
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Heaviness acts as the foundation to lightness. Stillness acts as a sovereign to restlessness. Therefore, sovereign masters travel all day And do not depart from [their] "light" heaviness: Even though there are luxurious sights, comforts, and	Being solid is the foundation of lightness. Being calm is the ruler of haste. Thus, the sage, when traveling all day, Never parts with his luggage. Seeing beautiful sights, He	HEAVY AND LIGHT CHARACTER As heaviness of character, honesty and generosity Are the root of lightness, frivolity and quick wit. So motion and activity spring from Serenity, tranquility and quietude. Thus the Sage: Even while traveling and moving about all day, Never loses his poise, Departs, not	Being solid creates a lighthearted foundation. Unresponsive stillness makes an agitated master. The sages all day go forward and do not separate themselves from their heavy load. Though they have beautiful perception, they stay calm in an undisturbed	Serenity is wiser than superficiality, dignity is master of turbulence. The sage does not step off the path of serenity. He is not distracted by unruly passions, angered in contemplation nothing can perturb him.
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places— They rightly rise above [such things]. How does the lord of ten thousand chariots endure And yet consider himself to be unimportant in the world? Frivolous laws lose [one's] foundation. Rash laws lose [one's] sovereignty.	remains unconcerned and calm. Will the ruler of the myriad chariots Let himself be frivolous? If he's frivolous he will lose his foundations. If he's rash he will lose rulership.	from his true nature. Tho' presented with magnificence, beauty, grace, glory, honor, splendor, and comfort, He remains calm, leisurely, quiet and dispassionate. The leader with great responsibility, Conducting himself with frivolity, Imperils himself, and he will fail. Exercising hasty restless action,	manner. Their resources are what a master of ten-thousand chariots has, yet they are a person who moves lightly in Heaven below (the sacred body). Disregard follows the loss of their foundation. Restlessness follows the loss of this master.	Woe, if the ruler of the land considers himself more important than the realm. His follower loses, who succumbs to frivolity, His dominance loses, who is driven by passions.
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Good traveling is without tracks or footprints. Good speech is without faulting or blaming. Good counting does not use tallying methods. Good closing is without bars or locks and cannot be opened. Good binding is without ropes or restraints and cannot be unfastened. Therefore, the sages Are always good at helping people— Consequently, they do not cast people aside. Are always good at helping the physical	Those who are good at walking Leave no tracks in the ground. Those who are good at speaking Speak without flaws. Those who are good at counting Require no tally. Those who are good at shutting Use no locks Yet whatever they close Cannot be opened. Those who are good at tying Use no ropes Yet whatever they tie Cannot be untied. Thus the sage is always good at taking care of	THE PERFECT Running perfectly, Neither track nor trace is seen. Speaking perfectly, Neither slip nor flaw. Calculating perfectly, Neither tally nor counter is needed. The perfect door, needing neither bolt nor bar, Cannot be opened. The perfect knot, needing neither rope nor twine Cannot be untied. Thus the Sage, Perfect in helping humankind, No one is rejected nor abandoned. Perfect in caring for All Things, Nothing is laid waste	Good practices leave no trace of a rut. Good words do not find fault. Good plans are not calculated. Good doors have no bolt or bar, yet cannot be opened. Good bindings have no ties, yet cannot be loosened. The sage is always good at embracing people because they do not abandon people. They are always good	An experienced wanderer needs neither guideposts nor paths. A good mathematician needs no counting board. A good orator needs no false arguments. A good locksmith needs no key. The Sage is a good helper of man and never despairs.
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world— Consequently, they do not cast the physical world aside. This is called "entering enlightenment." Therefore, those who are good Are the teachers of those who are not good. Those who are not good Are the resources of those who are good. Not valuing one's teachers Not loving one's resources Even though [one may be] intelligent [One is nevertheless] greatly confused. This is called an essential subtlety.	people And abandons no one. He's always good at looking after things And abandons nothing. This is called Following what's bright. The good are the teachers of those who are not good. Those who are not good are the raw material for the good. Those who do not respect their teachers And don't care for their resources However clever they may be, they're utterly confused. This is called the essence of mystery.	nor discarded. In so doing, cunningly secures knowledge of the laws of nature, And uses this knowledge in a Wu-Wei manner Therefore: As the perfect is the teacher of the imperfect, The imperfect is a valuable experience for the perfect. Either teacher - either student, Not honoring the teacher, Not loving and caring for the student, Though learned and wise, Is deluded and deceived.	at embracing all of life because they do not reject anything. This is called following the light. The good person is the bad person's teacher. The bad person is the good person's lesson. When the student does not value their teacher, they become cunning and very confused. They cannot cherish their lessons. This is called the essential mystery.	Such is his enlightenment. The Sage is the teacher of the confused, and values his pupil. Who does not honor his teacher, Who does not value his pupil, lacks wisdom in spite of his knowledge. Such is true Spirituality.
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Know the masculine. Keep to the feminine. Become for the world a valley. Being a valley for the world, Constant virtue does not leave. Return, go back to infancy. Know the white. Keep to the black. Become for the world an example. Being an example for the world, Constant virtue does not err. Return,	Be aware of what's masculine in you, But preserve what is feminine in you, And serve as a conduit for the world. When you serve as a conduit for the world Your true virtue will never be gone. And you'll return again to the state of a newborn child. Be aware of what is bright in you, But preserve what is dark in you, And serve as a guide for the world. When you serve a guide for the world Your true virtue will	YIN POWER She - Knowing the Yang, yet keeping to the Yin, Like a valley stream receives All Things under the heavens. Never departing from the eternal Te, Returns to the innocence of childhood. She - Knowing whiteness, lightness and glory, yet, Keeping to blackness, darkness and humility, becomes an example to the world. Never deviating from the eternal Te, Returns to the ultimate mysterious primordial essence.	Know your masculine. Maintain your feminine. Act in Heaven below's (the sacred body) valley. Act in Heaven below's valley. The eternal action of the soul does not divide or separate. Return and revert to your original state like that of a new born child. Know your purity. Observe your evil. Become an example of Heaven below. Become an example of Heaven below. The eternal action of the soul does not falter. Return and	Whoever is manly and strong, yet gentle of deeds, becomes the stream of the world, remains in steadfast virtue and returns to nature like a child. Whoever feels in himself the Light and fights Darkness becomes a symbol for the World. Whoever becomes a symbol for the world, steadfast in virtue, returns to the very substance of Being.
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go back to non-extremity. Know the glorious. Keep to the humble. Become for the world a waterway. Being a waterway for the world, Constant virtue indeed suffices. Return, go back to simplicity. Simplicity splits and then becomes instruments. The sages use them and then become governmental leaders. Thus, the Great System does not divide.	never falter, And you'll return again to the state of boundlessness. Be aware of what's praiseworthy in you, But preserve what is base in you, And serve as a valley for the world. When you serve as a valley for the world Your true virtue will grow ample enough, And you'll return again to the simplicity of uncut wood. Divided, the wood becomes a rod. Used by a sage, the rod becomes a ruler's staff.	She - Knowing honor and glory, yet, Keeping to obscurity and humility, becomes the receptive valley of the world. Being proficient in the eternal Te, Returns, as to an uncarved block. As uncarved wood is cut - The Tao is transformed into myriad things. The Sage, in using it, attains awesome power. A truly wise ruler is a careful carver, Ruling as sparsely and carefully as she carves.	revert to the origin through the highest emptiness. Know your beauty. Observe your shame. Act in Heaven below's empty spaces. Act in Heaven below's empty spaces. Eternal action of the soul is enough. Return and restore the purity of uncarved wood or uncut jade. Purity* disperses and becomes the vessel. The sage uses it and becomes an enduring leader. Hence great rulers do no harm	Whoever feels his own Height still lives in humility, becomes like a fertile valley. Whoever becomes a valley of the world, is of eternal virtue and returns to the very substance of Being. Man is like uncut timber, only intuitive insight brings about perfection. The Sage in his virtue is the first in his community. A true ruler has no need of aggression.
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Should some desire to take the world and run it— I see they cannot achieve [this]. The world is a spiritual device Not able to be run, besides. They who [try to] run it spoil it. They who hold	Those who wish to conquer the world and act upon it Do not achieve their goals - this is what I have found. The world is a perfect vessel. It cannot be acted upon. Those who act on it destroy it. Those who grab at	FOLLY OF HARD CONTROL Those who would conquer the world by making humankind and events conform to their desire, Never succeed - For the sovereignty of the world is subtle, sacred, spiritual. Tampering with it, shaping or changing it, Harms, mars, spoils and	If you have deep-seated desires to control Heaven below (the sacred body) and manipulate it, you will see that you do not benefit! Heaven below is a sacred vessel that cannot be manipulated! Manipulation destroys it. Seizing it separates you from your reason for existence. Sometimes you	Whoever wishes to rise by conquest will fail. The true goal in life is spiritual and can not be conquered by force. The aggressor destroys it. The conqueror loses it. Mankind is forever in change, Some run ahead, soon they fall back.
it in their hands lose it. Nature might prevail, might comply Might blow softly, might huff-and-puff Might be forceful, might win Might frustrate, might destroy Therefore, the sage lets go of extremes. Lets go of extravagance. Lets go of loftiness.	it lose it. Because with things: Some lead and some follow, Some blow hot and some blow cold, Some grow in strength and some weaken, Some expand and some collapse. That is why the sage rejects the excessive, Rejects the elaborate, And rejects the superfluous.	destroys it. Reaching for it, grabbing or grasping at it, It is gone - lost. There exists constant alternation - Advance - Retreat Blowing Hot - Blowing Cold Strength - Weakness Rise - Fall The Sage, therefore, avoids all extremes, extravagances and excesses.	will progress, sometimes you will imitate. Sometimes you will breath out, sometimes you will breathe in. Sometimes you will be strong, sometimes you will be weak. Sometimes you will break, sometimes you will be broken. This is why the sage rejects extremes, rejects extravagances, and rejects excesses.	Some are powerful, soon they weaken. Some are fiery, soon they are cold. Some are victorious, soon defeated. The Sage is not moved by earthly ambitions, he avoids self aggrandizement, he avoids self elevation.

Those rulers who use the Tao to assist mankind Do not use soldiers to force the world. Those doings can be paid back [to them]. The place of the army's encampment— Thorns and brambles grow there. In the wake of the military There indeed exists a famine-year. The good have	When the follower of Tao assists the ruler, He'll advise him Not to conquer the world with the force of arms. Such actions will certainly rebound. Thistles spring up where armies camp. Bad harvests follow in the wake of great wars. Attain your goal, then stop And do not	USE OF FORCE The wise leader of people, in following ,the Tao, Conquers without using force of arms, For it is in the nature of direct force to rebound - violence begetting violence, repaying the wielder in kind. Knowing that forceful conflict produces a battleground of thorns and bramble extending far beyond the point of conflict, It is inevitable that conflict be followed by great famine and deprivation. A wise leader effects the purpose at hand, and stops	With the Tao guiding the people the rulers do not have a reason to use weapons and violence. Heaven below's (sacred body's) activities will return to the highest degree. The master knows when to stop, for brambles and thorny bushes live there. Great battles are postponed, or surely there would be disaster for years. The results are good when one	Whoever advises the ruler in the spirit of Tao will avoid rule by force of arms: force begets force. Where armies are arrayed against each other, grow thistle and thorn. Wars are the parents of hunger and misery.
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success and stop Not daring thereby to grab for power. [They] succeed but never boast. Succeed but never strike down. Succeed but never arrogantly. Succeed but do not gain thereafter. Succeed but never force. A strong thing ruling over what is Old— This is called "non-Tao." The non-Tao soon ends.	abuse your force. Attain your goal without boasting. Attain your goal without bragging. Attain your goal without pride. Attain your goal without gain. Attain your goal without violence. What expands too much is bound to collapse. This is not the way of Tao. What goes against Tao soon declines.	- Not continuing the use of power for its own sake. Achieving the purpose: - Does not brag about it. - Does not boast of it. - Does not take pride in it. - Considers any conflict an unavoidable and regrettable necessity. - Does not delight in domination and violence. Knowing that loss follows gain, decay follows vigor and that violence is not consistent with the Tao, Then that which is inconsistent with the Tao, Must in time, perish.	does not venture to rule by force. They succeed yet do not brag. They succeed yet do not destroy. They succeed yet are not arrogant. They succeed yet do not possess! They succeed yet do not overpower. Life flourishes and then decays. This is sometimes spoken of as not the Tao. Not the Tao is when life ends before its time.	The Sage wants peace, nothing else, he aspires never for conquest. He is victorious in restraint, victorious with arrogance, victorious without presumption, victorious without demonstration and offense. Whoever seeks military adventures will perish in them. Such is the fate of rapaciousness. Such is the fate of materialism.
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Those who delight in the military are instruments of ill fortune—

Nature perhaps detests them.

Therefore, those who possess the Tao do not dwell [with them].

Sovereign masters, [while at] home, necessarily value the left.

Using the military necessarily values the right.

Those who are warlike are instruments of ill fortune

Not the instruments of the sovereign master.

[When the situation is] already disharmonious

And [they have to] use them

[They do so] calmly, without relish, [thus] becoming superior.

[They] "win" but do not delight [in —

it —

Fine weapons are the
portents of evil.
Creatures seem to
detest them.
So the people of Tao
keep away from them.
In times of peace the
wise favor the left side.
In times of war they
favor the right.
Weapons are the
portents of evil.
Not the tools of the
wise.
Compelled to use them,
They do so without
zeal.
Winning a victory,
They do not relish in it.
Those who

ARMS AND WEAPONS

Arms and weapons,
Being instruments of destruction, Are
despised by all.

They are avoided by
followers of the Tao.

As instruments of evil,
they are spurned by good
leaders,

Being used with calm
restraint only when no
other choice prevails.

A good leader does not
regard victory with
rejoicing,

For to delight in victory
is to delight
in the slaughter of
people.

To delight in slaughter is
to fail

Those who are superior at warfare do not have good fortune.

They are likely to be detested.

The emergence of the Tao does not stop.

The honorable ruler dwells in and emulates this (the Tao) because they favor the left side.

Using weapons emulates and favors the right side.

Weapons are not a blessing and are not useful.

The honorable ruler does not obtain these instruments! Yet they still can function.

Tranquility and quiet become supreme.

Conquering has no beauty because it is as if you rejoice and delight at the slaughter of people.

Truly

—	delight in victory
—	Delight in the slaughter
—	of people.
—	Those who delight in
—	slaughter
—	Cannot attain their
—	goals.
—	On happy occasions the
—	left is the place of
—	honor.
—	On mournful occasions
—	- the right.
—	The rites of war are like
—	the funeral rites:
—	The generals stand on
—	the left,
—	The
—	commander-in-chief on
—	the right.
—	When multitudes are
—	killed the mourners
—	should grieve.

one's purpose.

In ancient social custom -

The left is the place of honor

for ceremonies at home.

At war, the place of honor is at the right.

Thus,

Good omen and happy occasions favor the left.

Ill omen and such sad occasions as

funeral rites, favor the right.

Observe then with grief and sorrow the slaughter accompanying victory of arms, for,

Victory of arms and funeral ceremony

to rejoice at the killing of people means you will not be able to fulfill your ambitions for Heaven below (the sacred body)!

Joyful activities add to the left side.

Cruel activities add to the right side.

The person who acts from below will approach the battle and dwell in the left side.

The person who acts from above will approach the battle and dwell in the right side.

Speak as though performing funeral rites.

Killing causes the people to grieve and weep with sorrow.

Tremble at victory because life will be like a funeral ceremony.

To consider this desirable would be to delight in the slaughter of men; and he who delights in the slaughter of men cannot get his will in the kingdom. On occasions of festivity to be on the left hand is the prized position; on occasions of mourning, the right hand. The second in command of the army has his place on the left; the general commanding in chief has his on the right; his place, that is, is assigned to him as in the rites of mourning. He who has killed multitudes of men should weep for them with the bitterest grief; and the victor in battle has his place (rightly) according to those rites.

The Tao is always without renown. Although it is "simple" and "small" The world is altogether unable to subjugate it. Lords and kings, if they could maintain it— The ten-thousand things would submit themselves. Heaven and Earth with each other would combine Thereby raining down sweet dew. No humans command them, and they are	Tao is invariably nameless. Simple like uncut wood, it seems insignificant Yet no one in the world can command it. If kings and lords could follow it The myriad things would salute them, Heaven and earth would unite And soft	THE UNCARVED BLOCK The Tao, eternal and nameless, Is as an uncarved block - Seemingly simple and insignificant, Is inferior to nothing under the heavens. If leaders were to embrace it within their own true natures, Loyalty would come to them as effortlessly as heaven and earth send the rains and dew. There being no compulsion, All	The Tao is eternal and not named. Even though simple and subtle, no one in Heaven below (the sacred body) can rule over it! When all people can sustain it, ten-thousand things (everything) will naturally honor it as they would honor a guest. Heaven and Earth are mutually joined and drip with sweet dew. The people are without laws and	The Tao, considered as unchanging, has no name. — Though in its primordial simplicity it may be small, the whole world dares not deal with (one embodying) it as a minister. If a feudal prince or the king could guard and hold it, all would spontaneously submit themselves to him. —
naturally equitable. At the beginning establishment, there existed names. Names also since then existed. One should also know [when] to stop [naming]. Knowing [when] to stop, one can thereby be in no danger. Simile: The living presence of the Tao in the world Is like unto valley streams Going into larger rivers	dew would fall, People would live in harmony Without any need for laws. Begin to cut, begin to rule And names will appear. When names abound dividing must stop. The Tao of the world is like rivers flowing into the sea.	would be in harmony. Carving the block creates identity. Identity causes names. Names cause differentiation and distinction - Harmony ceases. Thus, As names are perceived - As distinctions among people arise - Stop! Knowing when to stop, danger may be avoided.	are naturally in harmony. When rules began, their names emerged. From their names, exhaustion emerged. The master will recognize that in which the mind rests, and knows that when the mind rests there is no danger. They compare this to the Tao's presence in Heaven below. It resembles the valley streams that become the great rivers that flow into the sea.	Heaven and Earth (under its guidance) unite together and send down the sweet dew, which, without the directions of men, reaches equally everywhere as of its own accord. As soon as it proceeds to action, it has a name.

Those who understand people are wise. Those who understand themselves are luminous. Those who triumph over people have forcefulness. Those who triumph over themselves have strength. Those who	Those who know others are clever. Those who know themselves are enlightened. Those who conquer others have strength. Those who conquer themselves are powerful. Those who	KNOWING ONESELF To know and understand others, Is to have wisdom. To know and understand oneself, Is to have wisdom and enlightenment. To conquer others, Is to have physical force. To conquer oneself, Is to have physical force as well as internal	Recognize that people naturally know. Knowing the light sustains humanity. This naturally emerging force overcomes violence. Knowing the light provides strength	He who knows other men is discerning; he who knows himself is intelligent. He who overcomes others is strong; he who overcomes himself is mighty. He who is satisfied with his lot is rich;
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know sufficiency are rich. Those who work vigorously have determination. That which does not lose its place lasts long. That which dies but does not perish lives long.	are contented have wealth. Those who move ahead have purpose. Those who don't run away from their posts endure. Those who die but don't perish live on.	strength. To be content with what one has, Is to be rich indeed. To act with perseverance, Is to be strong willed. To preserve one's natural essence, Is to endure. To die, Is not to perish. One's eternal presence is true longevity.	in action. Resolve to not separate from it. The light is enduring. Death is not the end. The light is immortal.	he who goes on acting with energy has a (firm) will. He who does not fail in the requirements of his position, continues long; he who dies and yet does not perish, has longevity.
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The great Tao is a flood! It can [go] left and right. The ten-thousand things rely upon it for their livelihood And it does not refuse them. It achieves and accomplishes but has no prestige. It clothes and rears the ten-thousand things But does not act as lord [over	Great Tao flows like a flood. It can go left and right. The myriad things depend on it for life And it does not forsake them. It does its work but lays claim to no merit. It shields and nourishes the myriad things And does not act	GREATNESS The great Tao, flowing everywhere, May go this way or that, To the left or to the right. All Things depending upon it for existence, It is generous, no grace is withheld. Silently and freely fulfilling its purpose and destiny, It lays no possessive claim. Nourishing and protecting All Things,	The great Tao is the cycle of life! It can move to the left and to the right.* Ten-thousand things (everything) rely upon it and it gives birth and does not refuse. It deserves praise for the whole which cannot be named. It clothes and nourishes ten-thousand things and does not act like a ruler. It is always without deep seated desires. Its name is associated with everything including the small.	All-pervading is the Great Tao! It may be found on the left hand and on the right. All things depend on it for their production, which it gives to them, not one refusing obedience to it. When it gives to them, not one refusing obedience to it. When its work is accomplished, it does not claim the name of having done it.
them]. Always without desire, it can then be named "With the Lowly." The ten-thousand things return there And it does not act as lord [over them]. It can be named "Being Great." Because it at no time takes itself to be great Is the reason it can achieve its greatness.	as their lord. Always desireless it may seem insignificant, Yet the myriad things return to it And it does not act as their lord. Thus it may seem to be great. The sage, too, does not strive to be great So he is able to achieve greatness.	no desire to be master over them. Without desire, asking for nothing, Some may call it "The Small". However, All Things belonging and returning to it - Tho' it lays no claim to master them, It is called "The Great". Thus the Sage Never making a show of greatness - Manifests true greatness.	original state, and from that place do not act as rulers. The Name** becomes great because until the end, it is not great and does not act great. Thus it can succeed in its greatness. * Left and right = Being to the right of the ruler was considered a place of honor. Being to the left of the ruler was considered second best. **The Name = The universe becoming conscious of itself through its human form.	It clothes all things as with a garment, and makes no assumption of being their lord;-it may be named in the smallest things. All things return (to their root and disappear), and do not know that it is it which presides over their doing so;-it may be named in the greatest things. Hence the sage is able (in the same way) to accomplish his great achievements. It is through his not making himself great that he can accomplish them.

Hold the Great Shape
in your hands.
The world departs.
Departs and does not
harm—
Peaceful and leveled
to the extreme.
[For] music and
dumplings
Do the passing
travelers stop.
But the going forth of
the

Embrace the great
idea
And the whole world
will come to you.
It'll come to you and
suffer no harm.
It'll find no peril but
contentment and
peace.
Travelers stop for
food and for music
Yet it is said of

TAO PRESENCE
Tao presence in
mind,
Quietude, comfort
and harmony appear.
As music pleasures
the soul -
As fine food delights
the senses -
Passing strangers
take

Take hold of and
follow Heaven
below's (the sacred
body's) elephant*.
Follow and there will
be no loss, quiet
peace is in
abundance.
Food and music will
make passing
strangers stop.
The Tao that goes
forth by words

To him who holds in
his hands the Great
Image (of the
invisible Tao), the
whole world repairs.
Men resort to him,
and receive no hurt,
but (find) rest, peace,
and the feeling of
ease.
Music and dainties
will make

Tao is insipid to the
mouth
From its being
without flavor.
Inspecting it is not
sufficient to see it.
Listening for it is not
sufficient to hear it.
Using it is not
sufficient to exhaust
it.

Tao
That it is tasteless
and bland.
When you look at it,
there's not enough of
it to see.
When you listen to it,
there's not enough of
it to hear.
Yet, when you use it,
you can't use it up.

note, pause to enjoy.
Compare then the
Tao -
Flavorless to the
taste.
Unseen to the eye.
Unheard to the ear.
Tho' using it - it is
inexhaustible.

is tasteless!
It is without taste.
Those who think
about it cannot see it.
Those who listen for
it cannot hear it.
Use it and it can
never be exhausted.
* Elephant: a symbol
of strength, peace
and abundance.

the passing guest
stop (for a time).
But though the Tao
as it comes from the
mouth, seems insipid
and has no flavour,
though it seems not
worth being looked
at or listened to,
the use of it is
inexhaustible.

Should one wish to condense it, one must certainly expand it. Should one wish to weaken it, one must certainly strengthen it. Should one wish to abolish it, one must certainly boost it. Should one wish to receive it, one must	If you wish to make something small You have to expand it. If you wish to make something weak You have to strengthen it. If you wish to make something fall You have to promote it. If you wish to make something	THE SUBTLE LAW Expansion grows from contraction. Strength grows from weakness. Construction grows from destruction. Receiving grows from giving. Being the subtle law of nature, Softness and	To be at peace with your deep-seated desires, you surely must expand. To soften your deep-seated desires, you surely must be vigorous. To give up your deep-seated desires, you surely must flourish. To deprive your deep-seated desires, you surely must	When one is about to take an inspiration, he is sure to make a (previous)expiration; when he is going to weaken another, he will first strengthenhim; when he is going to overthrow another, he will first have raised himup; when he is going to despoil another, he will first have made giftsto him:-this is called 'hiding the light (of his procedure).' The softovercomes the hard; and the weak the strong.
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certainly give it. This is called "subtle illumination." The flexible and weak overcome the firm and strong. Fish are not able to escape from the deeps— The beneficial tools of the state Are not able, therefore, to be shown to people.	gone You have to provide it. This is called Darkening what's bright. What's soft and weak defeats what's hard and strong. Fish should not be taken away from the ocean. Sharp weapons of the state Should not be shown to the people.	gentleness overcome the hard and the strong. As fish are preserved by hiding in the deep, Preserve your weapons of survival from the view of the Idle Curious.	give of yourself. This is called the mystery of the light. The gentle and the yielding overcome the hard and the forceful. Force cannot separate you from your watery abyss (deep-seated desires). The community's acquisitions cannot help you to know yourself.	Fishes should not be takenfrom the deep; instruments for the profit of a state should not be shown to the people.
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The Tao is always not "doing" And yet nothing is not done. Lords and kings, if they could maintain it— The ten-thousand things would transform themselves. Transformed, [should] they yet desire to "act"	Tao invariably takes no action Yet there is nothing left undone. If kings and lords could follow it The myriad things would transform by themselves. And should they wish to take action	NEVER DOING Tao never does, Yet through it, All Things are done. If leaders observed this, All would develop naturally. Desire for active doing	The Tao is eternal not doing (wu wei) yet does everything. When all people can uphold it, ten-thousand things (everything) will naturally evolve. When I am influenced by deep-seated desires, I will restrain them without naming them in	The tao in its regular course does nothing (for the sake of doing it), and so there is nothing which it does not do. If princes and kings were able to maintain it, all things would of themselves be transformed by them.
I would cool them with the simplicity of the Nameless. The simplicity of the Nameless A man would also not desire. [By] not desiring [and] by means of stillness The world shall stabilize itself.	once more I'd quiet them With nameless simplicity. The nameless simplicity Is like uncut wood: It has no desires. Without desires there is tranquility And heaven and earth become stable by themselves.	would be restrained by the inherent simplicity of Tao. Being free of desire, Stillness and tranquility reign. Of itself, All Things are at peace.	order to keep my purity. By focusing on the uncarved block of wood or the uncut jade, the master will be without deep-seated desires. Without deep-seated desires there is tranquility in Heaven below (the sacred body) and peace follows.	If this transformation became to me an object of desire, I would express the desire by the nameless simplicity. Simplicity without a name. Is free from all external aim. With no desire, at rest and still, All things go right as of their will.

Those which of old obtained the One:	In days of old these became whole:	THE UNIFIED WHOLE	In ancient times there was unity.	The things which from of old have got the One (the Tao) are
Heaven obtained the One and thus clarity.	Having become whole, heaven became clear.	From ancient times, there was an understanding of All Things as a unified whole,	Heaven benefited from unity and became pure.	Heaven which by it is bright and pure; Earth rendered thereby firm and sure; Spirits with powers by it supplied; Valleys kept full through their void; All creatures which through it do live; Princes and kings who from it get The model which to all they give.
Earth obtained the One and thus repose.	Having become whole, earth became stable.	Arising as from one.	Earth benefited from unity and became stabilized.	All these are the results of the one (Tao).
Spirits obtained the One and thus animation.	Having become whole, spirits became vibrant.	Understanding and possessing this unity:	The soul benefited from unity and became divine.	If heaven were not thus pure, it soon would rend; If earth were not thus sure, 'twould break and bend; Without these powers, the spirits soon would fail; If not so filled, the drought would parch each vale; Without that life, creatures would pass away; Princes and kings,
Waterways obtained the One and thus fullness.	Having become whole, valleys became full.	- Heaven attains purity and clarity.	The valleys benefited from unity and became bountiful.	
The ten-thousand things obtained the One and thus livelihood.	Having become whole, the myriad things became alive.	- Earth attains stability and tranquility.	Ten-thousand things (everything) benefited from unity and were born.	
Lords and kings obtained the One and thus became dedicated to the world.	Having become whole, the nobles set the realm right.	- Spirit attains life and essence.	All people benefited from unity and became Heaven below's (the sacred body's) high principle.	
This conveys it:	This is what they achieved by becoming whole.	- Valley attains fullness and fruitfulness.	They achieved this.	
Heaven, without means of clarity, would fearfully split open.	If heaven had not become clear	- All Things attain creative life and growth.	Without purity, fear would split Heaven apart.	
Earth, without means of repose, would fearfully be terminated.	It would likely break open.	- Leaders attain responsiveness.	Without solidity, fear would cause the Earth to crumble.	
Spirits, without means of animation, would fearfully come to an end.	If earth had not become stable	All this - arising as from one, Is the true nature of things..	Without divinity, fear would shut down the soul.	
	It would likely collapse.	Were it not for:		
	If spirits had not become vibrant	- Purity and clarity, the heavens would cease.		

—	—	—	fear would deplete the valleys.	without that moralsway, However grand and high, would all decay.
—	—	—	Without birth, fear would cause the ten-thousand things to perish.	
—	—	—	Without taking in hand their exalted treasure, fear would cause the people to stumble.	
—	—	—	Thus, value is rooted in humble action.	
—	—	—	High positions are humble and form the foundation.	
—	—	—	When people say orphans and widows are not worthy, it surely is not the root of humble action.	
—	—	—	Surely not!	
—	—	—	Therefore, looking for praise does not bring success.	
—	—	—	Do not desire to sparkle, sparkle like a jewel.	
—	—	—	Instead, resemble a necklace, a necklace of rocks.	
—	—	—		
—	—	—		
—	—	—		
—	—	—		
—	—	—		

"Return" is the motion of the Tao.
 "Weakening" is the function of the Tao.

Returning is the action of Tao.
 Yielding is the function of Tao.
 The myriad

THE NON-BEING
 Returning to what was in the beginning,
 Is the action of Tao.
 Gentleness and yielding is the

Return to your true nature, the movement of the Tao.
 The way of the Tao is gentle.
 Ten-thousand things

The movement of the Tao By contraries proceeds;
 And weakness marks the course of Tao's mighty deeds.
 All

The world and the ten-thousand things were born to existence.
 Existence was born to non-existence.

things arise from what there is.
 What there is arises from what there is not.

manner in which Tao functions and employs itself.
 All Things emanate from Being,
 And being, most certainly emanates from
 Non-Being.

(everything) and Heaven below (the sacred body) were born from its existence.
 Existence was born from nonexistence (the Source).

things under heaven sprang from it as existing (and named);
 that existence sprang from
 It as non-existent (and not named).

High scholars hear of the Tao attentively and practice it. Middling scholars hear of the Tao— They seem to keep it [sometimes], seem to lose it [at other times]. Low scholars hear of the Tao— They greatly deride it. Not deriding is not sufficient to be the Tao. This is the reason that [among the] established sayings there are these: "The clear Tao seems obscure." "Making progress in the Tao seems like going	When the best students hear of Tao They follow it with all their might. When average students hear of Tao Sometimes they heed it sometimes they don't. When the worst students hear of Tao They laugh at it heartily. Were it not laughed at, Tao would not be what it is. Thus it is said: A path that is bright seems to be dim. A path going forward seems to go back. A path that is	HOW IT MAY SEEM A wise person, hearing of the Tao, Lets it become a central focus of life. A mediocre person, hearing of the Tao, Keeps to it or not, as the occasion, may suggest. An inferior person, hearing of the Tao, Laughs aloud at it. Truly, being inferior, had he failed to laugh at it - It most certainly would not be worthy to be called the Tao. Hence it is said: - The bright way may seem dimly lit. - The way ahead may seem like a retreat. - The straight way may seem to be wavy and —	The master who acts from above strains to listen to the Tao, and becomes exhausted. The master who acts from the middle hears the Tao very faintly, and then loses it. The master who acts from below hears the Tao and laughs greatly. Those who are unable to laugh will not have enough of a reason to practice the Tao. Thus we can say: The luminous Tao seems dark. The advancing Tao seems to retreat. The smooth Tao appears flawed. The highest action of	Scholars of the highest class, when they hear about the Tao, earnestly carry it into practice. Scholars of the middle class, when they have heard about it, seem now to keep it and now to lose it. Scholars of the lowest class, when they have heard about it, laugh greatly at it. If it were not (thus) laughed at, it would not be fit to be the Tao. Therefore the sentence makers have thus expressed themselves:- 'The Tao, when brightest seen, seems light to lack: Who progress init makes, seems drawing back; Its even way is like a rugged track.
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backwards." "The smooth Tao seems flawed." "Superior virtue seems like a hollow." "Great purity seems like dishonor." "Extensive virtue seems insufficient." "Building virtue seems like whiling away without purpose." "True qualities seem to change." "A great region is without corners." "A great instrument is completed toward the end." "Great sound is rarely made known." "Great shape is without form." The Tao is hidden. Nameless.	smooth seems to be uneven. The highest virtue seems to be hollow. The purest white seems to be sullied. The amplest virtue seems insufficient. The firmest virtue seems unsteady. The genuine virtue seems to be fickle. The greatest realm is without boundaries. The finest talent matures late. Harmonious music makes no noise. The perfect form has no substance. Tao is hidden and nameless. Yet it is Tao that sustains all things	crooked. - The highest virtue may seem to be devoid of substance. - The pure may seem to be tarnished. - The greatest Te may seem inadequate. - The sturdiest Te may appear to be flimsy. - The natural way may appear contaminated. - The great square may appear with rounded corners. - The greatest talent may be slow to mature. - The most elegant music may be that which is faint. - The greatest images may be without shape. The Tao, hidden and nameless, Nourishing All Things,	the soul seems empty. Great purity appears degraded. Abundant action of the soul appears to not be enough. Stable action of the soul appears to be unsteady. Simple truth seems fickle. It is the great square that has no corners. It is the great vessel that is not complete. It is the great music that has no sound. It is the great elephant that has no form. The Tao is hidden without a name.	Its highest virtue from the vale doth rise; Its greatest beauty seems to offend the eyes; And he has most whose lot the least supplies. Its firmest virtue seems but poor and low; Its solid truth seems change to undergo; Its largest square doth yet no corner show; A vessel great, it is the slowest made; Loud is its sound, but never word it said; A semblance great, the shadow of a shade.' The tao is hidden, and has no name; but it is the Tao which is skilful at imparting (to all things what they need) and making them complete.
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The Tao gives birth to One One gives birth to Two Two gives birth to Three The three give birth to the ten-thousand things. The ten-thousand things take refuge in yin but harbor yang Infusing ch'i in order to act in harmony. That which is detested among people: Only [being] orphaned, bereft, unfortunate.	Tao gave birth to the One. One gave birth to the Two. Two gave birth to the Three. The Three gave birth to the myriad things. The myriad things have their backs in shadows Their faces bask in the light. Through the blending of life forces they achieve	ONE, TWO, THREE, MANY One, an undifferentiated unity, Comes from the Tao. One, differentiated, becomes two - Yin and Yang, I and Not I. Thence, are three realized - Such are Te, Ch'i and Shen. And from three, All Things arise. Of All Things - In carrying the Yin and embracing the Yang, Through the blending	The Tao gives birth to one. The one gives birth to two. The two gives birth to three. The three gives birth to ten-thousand things (everything). Ten-thousand things carry the yin (the physical) and hold the yang (the spiritual) within. The collision of these two vital forces (the chi) creates the totality that is humanity. Widows and orphans can	The Tao produced One; One produced Two; Two produced Three; Three produced all things. All things leave behind them the obscurity (out of which they have come), and go forward to embrace the Brightness (into which they have emerged), while they are harmonised by the Breath of Vacancy.
kings are indifferent to being [thus] called. Therefore, beings might decry them And yet [they are] profited. Might profit them and yet [they are] decried. That which is taught among people— I also teach it: Those who are swelling with violence Do not conquer their death. I will therefore take [these] teachings as [my] father.	harmony. "orphaned," "lonely" and "worthless" Are conditions which people detest Yet the nobles describe themselves with those names. Thus sometimes by losing we gain. And sometimes by gaining we lose. What others teach I also teach: "The violent have earned their death." This is the source of my teaching.	of these energies, Harmony is achieved. People disdain being orphaned, needy and worthless, Yet leaders and rulers, to appear humble, have so named themselves. By diminishing themselves, they often gain - By overt attempts to gain, they often lose. As the ancient spiritual teachers have said, The person living by violence,	connect Heaven, Humanity and Earth. The ministers who disdain them make titles for themselves. Sometimes things decrease and there is a gain. Sometimes with an increase, there is a loss. The lessons of others are also my lessons. The lessons of the forceful and aggressive do not create the necessary death. I receive each lesson, thus making it a beginning.	What men dislike is to be orphans, to have little virtue, to be as carriages without naves; and yet these are the designations which kings and princes use for themselves. So it is that some things are increased by being diminished, and others are diminished by being increased. What other men (thus) teach, I also teach. The violent and strong do not die their natural death. I will make this the basis of my teaching.

The softest [things]
in the world
[Are like] swift,
galloping horses
[To] the hardest
[things] in the world.
Non-existence enters
no-space.
We

The soft things of the
world can overcome
the hard ones.
Those that have no
substance can
penetrate the solid.

SOFTNESS AND
YIELDING
As water will wear
away stone,
So the softest and
most yielding will
overcome the hardest
and most obstinate.
Being without
substance,

Heaven below (the
sacred body) has
perfect flexibility and
moves like a
galloping horse.
Heaven below has
perfect strength.
Not being penetrates
emptiness.
I perceive

The softest thing in
the world dashes
against and
overcomes the
hardest; that which
has no (substantial)
existence enters
where there is no
crevice. I know
hereby

therefore know
That the occurrence
of non-action is
advantageous.
The teaching of
no-words
The advantages of
non-action—
The world rarely
matches them.

Therefore I know
non-action wins
success.
Teaching without
words,
Succeeding without
action -
These are understood
by the very few.

it penetrates the
spaceless.
Hence the value of
the silent action - The
actionlessness of
Wu-Wei.
Indeed, few
understand -
Teaching without
words,
Work without doing.

not doing (wu wei) as
the means to
advance.
Not speaking is its
philosophy.
Not doing benefits
the world.
Heaven below
soundlessly reaches
for it.

what advantage
belongs to doing
nothing (with a
purpose). There are
few in the world who
attain to the teaching
without words,
and the advantage
arising from
non-action.

Fame and the body: which is dear? The body and money: which is more? Gaining and losing: which is a fault? This is indeed the reason that excessive love	Your name or your life: which do you hold dearer? Your life or your wealth: which truly has value? Victory or loss: which truly gives pain? If you care to a fault you will certainly suffer. If	ENDURING SAFELY Does one's life and self character matter more than fame? Is one's Life and self character treasured more than wealth? Is loss of spiritual things more painful than gain of material things? Hence: Being attached to things while	Your body or your appearance, which do you love? Your body or wealth, which is worth more? Gain or loss, which is more difficult? Excessive love surely creates	Or fame of life, Which do you hold more dear? Or life or wealth, Towhich would you adhere? Keep life and lose those other things; Keep themand lose your life:-which brings Sorrow and pain more near?
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Most certainly exacts a great price. [After] much hoarding is certainly substantial loss. Knowing sufficiency, no dishonor. Knowing to stop, no danger. [One is] able thereby to last eternally.	you pile up your wealth you're bound to take a loss. If you are contented you meet with no disgrace. If you are able to stop you are free from danger. You can then last through all time.	grudging expense, One ultimately pays most dearly. Hoarding most heavily, One ultimately loses most heavily. Being content, One rarely suffers disappointment. Knowing when to stop, One is free from danger. In this way, one is safe and can long endure.	great expense. The more you hoard, the more you have to lose. Know contentment, not disappointment. Know how to stop before there is exhaustion. You can thus last long.	Thus we maysee, Who cleaves to fame Rejects what is more great; Who loves large storesGives up the richer state. Who is content Needs fear no shame. Who knowsto stop Incurs no blame. From danger free Long live shall he.
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Great completion seems incomplete. Its use is not worn-out. Great fullness seems empty. Its use is not exhausted. Great straightness seems bent. Great skill	Greatest perfection seems to be flawed Yet its usefulness is never impaired. Greatest abundance seems to be void Yet its usefulness never wears out. Greatest honesty seems to be dishonest. Greatest	TRANQUILITY Rare is that perfection which is not to some degree incomplete, Yet its utility is not impaired. Rare is the abundance which is not to some degree empty, Its fullness, tho', is not exhausted. Paradoxically: Ultimate straightness often seems crooked. Profound	Great perfection is with imperfection. Its use is not impaired. Great fullness is with emptiness Its usefulness is not exhausted. Great truth is with inaccuracies. Great	Who thinks his great achievements poor Shall find his vigour long endure.Of greatest fullness, deemed a void, Exhaustion ne'er shall stem the tide.Do thou what's straight still crooked
seems clumsy. Great argumentation seems slow of speech. Stillness overcomes restlessness. Coldness overcomes heat. Clear and still, become for the world what is correct.	ingenuity seems to be inept. Greatest eloquence seems like stammering. Being in motion overcomes the cold. Keeping calm overcomes the heat. Those who remain calm and pure Can set the world right.	skillfulness and intelligence often appears clumsy and stupid. Great eloquence often sounds as awkwardness and stammering. Movement overcomes the cold, but calm subdues all heat. The Sage, by his clarity, serenity and tranquility, Becomes a model for All Things under the heavens.	skill is with limitations. Great oratory is with stammering. Movement overcomes cold. Stillness overcomes heat. The act of pure tranquility guides Heaven below (the sacred body).	deem; Thy greatest art still stupidseem, And eloquence a stammering scream. Constant action overcomes cold; being still overcomes heat. Purityand stillness give the correct law to all under heaven.

[When] the world has the Tao [It] retires trotting horses to fertilize the soil. [When] the world lacks the Tao War horses are bred in the suburbs. Of misfortunes, there is	When the world follows Tao Carriage horses work on the farm fields. When the world lacks Tao War horses are bred outside city walls. There is no greater fault Than having	CONTENTMENT Of old - When the land was in harmony with the Tao, Horses were seen fertilizing and cultivating the land. When the land was out of harmony with the Tao, Horses were seen only on the battlefield. Alas:	When Heaven below (sacred body) is with the Tao, galloping horses* are curbed and used to haul dung. When Heaven below does not have the Tao, war horses breed on sacred ground. There is no greater	When the Tao prevails in the world, they send back their swift horsesto (draw) the dung-carts. When the Tao is disregarded in the world, thewarhorses breed in the border lands.
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none greater than not knowing sufficiency. Of faults, there is none greater than desiring gain. This is the reason that to know the sufficiency of sufficiency Is a lasting sufficiency indeed.	many desires, No greater defect Than not knowing when one has enough. No greater tragedy Than the desire to obtain. Thus knowing when one has enough Is to always have enough.	The paramount temptation is desire for the possessions of others. The paramount predicament is self-destructive harboring of discontent. The paramount misfortune is greed for acquisition. Therefore: Mastering contentment within one's own nature, Is to be truly content far all time.	misfortune than not knowing contentment. There is no greater downfall than having deep-seated desires. Know contentment. Your contentment is always enough! * The galloping horse is the symbol of sanctity, power and outstanding achievement of a nation.	There is no guilt greater than tosanction ambition; no calamity greater than to be discontented with one'slot; no fault greater than the wish to be getting. Therefore the sufficiencyof contentment is an enduring and unchanging sufficiency.
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Without going out
the door, know the
world.

Without peaking out
the windows, see the
Celestial Tao.

The more distant
one's going-out

The less one's

You don't need to
step through the door

To know the whole
world.

You don't need to
look from the
window

To see

KNOWING

Everything under
heaven may be
known by

Searching no further
than one's doorstep.

All ways of heaven
may be known

Despite shutters
blackening the
window's view.

The further one
pursues knowledge
by

Without going out
the door, you can
know Heaven below
(the sacred body).

Without looking
through a window,
you can see Heaven's
Tao.

The more you

Without going
outside his door, one
understands (all that
takes place) under the
sky; without looking
out from his window,
one sees the Tao
of Heaven.

knowledge is.

Therefore, the sages

Do not travel, and yet
know

Do not see, and yet
clearly understand

Do not "do," and yet
complete [their
work].

the way of heaven.

The farther you go,
the less you know.

Thus the sage knows
without traveling,

Understands without
seeing,

Achieves without
doing.

traveling apart from
the unity of the Tao,

The less is one's true
knowledge and
understanding.

The Sage:

Knows without
searching about.

Understands without
looking about.

Wu-Wei ! - Doing
nothing, all is
attained.

go away from
yourself, the less you
perceive.

The sage does not go
out, yet knows;

does not look, yet
names;

does not do, yet
finishes.

The farther that one
goes out (from
himself), the less he
knows. Therefore the
sages got their
knowledge without
traveling; gave their
(right) names to
things without seeing
them; and
accomplished their
ends without any
purpose of doing so.

Take learning to be daily increase. Take Tao to be daily decrease. Decrease upon decrease— Thereby arrive at non-action. Non-action and	The followers of knowledge gain something each day. The followers of Tao lose something each day. They lose and keep losing till they start doing nothing.	ACHIEVING INACTIVITY Increasing knowledge day by day, Is the pursuit of learning. Decreasing and simplifying day by day, Is the pursuit of Tao. Decreasing, subtracting, lessening, diminishing, Until inactivity is achieved. Through this inactivity, this	You will benefit when you let the sun come through the covered mind. Align with the Tao every day and your effort diminishes, diminishes, and diminishes. Hence you reach a state of not doing	He who devotes himself to learning (seeks) from day to day to increase(his knowledge): he who devotes himself to the Tao (seeks) from day today to diminish (his doings). He diminishes it and again diminishes it,till he arrives at doing nothing (on purpose).
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not "doing": Take the world always by non-administration. Until this [happens], there exists administration. [This is] not sufficient to take the world.	Yet though nothing is done, nothing is left undone. If you would conquer the world, refrain from meddling. If you meddle you cannot conquer the world.	pure spontaneity, All things happen - nothing is left undone. All is won by foregoing interference with the nature of things. The compulsion to actively manage All Things, Brings about the loss of All Things.	(wu wei), not doing, and nothing but not doing. Always without trying, take hold of Heaven below (the sacred body). When you stop trying, you will be able to take hold of Heaven below.	Having arrived at this pointof non- action, there is nothing which he does not do. He who gets as hisown all under heaven does so by giving himself no trouble (with that end).If one take trouble (with that end), he is not equal to getting as hisall under heaven.
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The sages are without fixed minds. Therefore, the hundred clans' mind Do [the sages] take to be [their own] mind. Those who are good, I am good to them. Those who are not good, I am also good to them. [This is] virtue [as] goodness. Those who are sincere, I am sincere	The sage does not have fixed ideas. He lets the thoughts of the others become his own. He is good to those who are good And to those who are not good. Virtue is good. He is faithful to those who are	COMMUNITY OF HEART Having an open and unconditioned mind - Foregoing preconceived opinions and feelings - The Sage regards the opinions and feelings of the people as his own. Being good and kind to the good and kindly - Being good and kind to the evil and unkindly - Goodness and kindness are attained, For Te is absolutely good and kind. Being faithful and	The sage has the emptiness of the eternal center. Thus the center of the hundred families (all families) becomes the center. Goodness - people are good. Those who are not good - they are also good because the action of their soul is good. Trust - people can be trusted. Those who	The sage has no invariable smind of his own; he makes the mind of the people his mind. To those who are good (to me), I am good; and to those who are not (to me), I am also good,-and thus (all) get to be good.
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to them. Those who are not sincere, I am also sincere to them. [This is] virtue [as] sincerity. The sages living in the world thereupon take everything in Acting in the world, merging their minds. The hundred clans—each one—pays attention with its ears and eyes. The sages all treat them as children.	faithful And to those who are not faithful. Virtue is faithful. The sage lives united with the world And he allows his thoughts to embrace all. The people fix on him their eyes and ears: He seems to behave like a little child.	honest to the faithful and honest - Being faithful and honest to the unfaithful, liar and cheat - Faithfulness and honesty are attained, For Te is absolutely faithful and honest. The Sage: Acting humble and shy, may appear confused to an objective world. But subtly, in a peaceful and harmonious manner, Regarding all as his children, Brings the world into a community of heart.	cannot be trusted - they can also be trusted because the action of their soul can be trusted. The sage lives peacefully in Heaven below (the sacred body). The peaceful action of Heaven below is like an ocean at its center. The sage is like a child ready to smile at everyone.	To those who are sincere (with me), I am sincere; and to those who are not sincere (with me), I am also sincere;-and thus (all) get to be sincere. The sage has in the world an appearance of indecision, and keeps his mind in a state of indifference to all. The people all keep their eyes and ears directed to him, and he deals with them all as his children.
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Produced by birth, entering into death: The disciples of life are three out of ten. The disciples of death are three out of ten. The lives of people That move them toward a death on the earth: [Of these] are there also three out of ten. Why? Because of their living the thickness of life. But hear of those [one in ten] who are	Seeking life we find death. There are thirteen passageways of life. There are thirteen passageways of death. People take those thirteen passageways of death And their lives proceed toward death. Why? People care too much about life. It has been said: Those who are good at staying alive Meet no	COMPANIONS OF LIFE AND DEATH Aiming at life, death is achieved. The limbs and apertures, forming thirteen companions during life, The same thirteen, serve also as companions of death. These thirteen companions of the life to death transition, Serve as points of vulnerability - Repaying the intense overtaxing of one's life force. The Sage:	The Source gives life and penetrates death.* Life is a companion to the four directions that exist within Heaven, Humanity and Earth. Death is a companion to the four directions that exist within Heaven, Humanity and Earth. People are born, live, and die, on earth, also as companions to the four directions that exist within Heaven, Humanity and Earth. What is the purpose? To give life. To give life abundantly. Indeed, we have heard of people who are good at sustaining life. On land they travel	Men come forth and live; they enter (again) and die. Of every ten there are ministers of life (to themselves); and three are ministers of death. there are also three in every ten whose aim is to live, but whose movements tend to the land (or place) of death. And for what reason? Because of their excessive endeavours to perpetuate life.
good at negotiating life: Traveling by land, they do not encounter the cruel or the fierce. Entering into an army, they are not covered with armor or weapons. The cruel have no place to thrust their spear-tips The fierce have no place to use their claws Soldiers find no place to receive their blades. Why?	buffaloes or tigers in the wilderness, They've no use for armor and weapons on the battleground. A buffalo can find no place to mark in them. A tiger can find no place to claw. A weapon can find no place to cut. Why? There is no place for death in them.	about does not meet threats of danger. In battle, is untouched by the warrior's weapons. Not aiming at life - Has no points of vulnerability, - For the horns of the buffalo to pierce. - For the claws of the tiger to tear. - For the weapons of the warrior to enter. He is beyond mortality.	and do not encounter rhinoceroses. Tigers enter the battlefield and they do not need to wear armor or carry weapons. Rhinoceroses have no place to butt with their horns. Tigers have no place to put their claws. Soldiers have no place to thrust their blades. How can this be so? Because of the not-dying** Earth. * The life force energy from the Source penetrates what is dead and brings it more alive. ** Not-dying means the absence of death, as not-doing means the absence of doing.	But I have heard that he who is skillful in managing the life entrusted to him for a time travels on the land without having to avoid buff coat or sharp weapon. The rhinoceros finds no place in him into which to thrust its horn, not the tiger a place in which to fix its claws, nor the weapon a place to admit its point. And for what reason? Because there is in him no place of death.

The Tao gives birth to them Virtue rears them Nature forms them Conditions complete them. Therefore, of the ten-thousand things There are none that do not honor the Tao And value Virtue. The honoring of the Tao The valuing of Virtue: Man does not command them [to do s —	Tao gives life to all things. Virtue nourishes them. Material world gives them form. Circumstances make them complete. Therefore of the myriad things, Each one reveres Tao And each one pays tribute to virtue. They do so without being ordered. They do so of themselves. Tao gives life to them.	TE AND All THINGS As Tao gives birth to All Things, Te provides the nourishment to rear them - To shape them and form them - Permitting each to realize the capacity within. As Tao is revered and worshipped, Te is exalted and honored by All Things. Such, being neither requested nor demanded, Is the nature of things, Happening spontaneously, of its own —	The Tao gives life to them. The action of the soul nourishes them. The material world shapes them. Circumstances perfect them. The ten-thousand things (everything) all honor the Tao and favor the action of the soul. They revere the Tao. The action of the soul is their treasure. Above all, it is without destiny, yet always is as it is. Hence, the Tao	All things are produced by the Tao, and nourished by its outflowing operation. They receive their forms according to the nature of each, and are completed according to the circumstances of their condition. Therefore all things without exception honour the Tao, and exalt its outflowing operation. This honouring of the Tao and exalting of its operation is not the result of any ordination, but always a spontaneous tribute.
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And they are always genuinely themselves Because the Tao gives birth to them And Virtue raises them Leads them, nourishes them Erects them, poisons them Supports them, destroys them. Giving birth but not possessing Acting but not presuming Leading but not oppressively ruling— This is called "Mystic Virtue."	Virtue nourishes and matures them. It teaches them and protects them. It rests them, supports them and guards them. Tao gives life to them but it does not possess them. It toils for them but expects no praise. It guides them but does not dominate them. This is the secret virtue.	accord. Arising from the Tao, By Te, are All Things nourished, developed, cared for, sheltered, comforted, grown and protected. In rearing All Things, It seeks neither to lay claim nor possess them. Acting as a help and guide, It seeks neither credit nor reward. Leading them, It seeks neither to master nor control.	gives life to them. The action of the soul - gives birth to them - sustains them - nurtures them - protects them - prepares them - feeds them - shelters them - gives them life and does not possess them - acts and does not presume - develops and does not rule	Thus it is that the Tao produces (all things), nourishes them, brings them to their full growth, nurses them, completes them, matures them, maintains them and overspreads them. It produces them and makes no claim to the possession of them; it carries them though their processes and does not vaunt its ability in doing so; it brings them to maturity and exercises no control over them;—this is called mysterious operation.
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The world had a beginning. It's regarded as being a mother to the world. Having attained its mother Thereby know its offspring. Having known its offspring Return, hold to its mother. Not having a body, there is no danger. Stop the exchange Close the openings Throughout, the	The universe had a beginning. This beginning is the mother of all. When you know the mother, You know her children, too. When you know the children, Go back to be with the mother And throughout your life you will suffer no harm. Close the passageways, Lock the entryways And throughout your life you will not get worn	MOTHER AND CHILDREN Being the essence, the universal beginning, It is known as the Mother of All Things. Knowing the Mother, the essence, the Tao - All Things, being children of the Mother, are likewise known. In truly knowing the children, Better is the understanding of the Mother. Harm and danger are forever elusive. In silence and moderation	Heaven below (the sacred body) has a beginning that was made by Heaven below's mother. When the mother finished, she recognized her child. When she recognized her child, she held it again. Till the end the body is not in danger. Close your openings, shut your gates, to the end of your days your body will not	"> (The Tao) which originated all under the sky is to be considered as the mother of them all. When the mother is founded, we know what her children should be. When one knows that he is his mother's child, and proceeds to guard (the qualities of) the mother that belong to him, to the end of his life he will be free from all peril. Let him keep his mouth closed, and shut up the portals (of his nostrils), and all his life he will be exempt from laborious exertion.
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body does not strive. Open the exchange Abet the affairs Throughout, the body is not helped. Seeing the lowly is called illumination. Maintaining flexibility is called strength. Use the light. Return, go back to the illumination. Not losing the body is a disaster. Indeed, be practicing always.	out. Open the passageways, Multiply your concerns And throughout your life you will not be saved. If you see the insignificant you have discernment. If you can remain flexible you are strong. Use the rays and return to the source of light. Do not be the cause of your own distress.	of sensory disturbance, Life's strengths are maintained. In babble and meddlesome activity, Life's burdens prevail. Seeing the subtle and small is true vision. Yielding, is the display of true strength. Using wisely our worldly resources - the "Outer Lights", The "Inner Lights" of true self are awakened and known. Thus, eluding harm and danger,	be exhausted. Open your mouth, meddle in your affairs, to the end of your days, your body will not be taken care of. Recognize that what is subtle is called the light. Put its brilliance to use. Return to the original state of the light. The body is not in danger. This is called the eternal practice.	Let him keep his mouth open, and (spend his breath) in the promotion of his affairs, and all his life there will be no safety for him. The perception of what is small is (the secret of) clear-sightedness; the guarding of what is soft and tender is (the secret of) strength. Who uses well his light. Reverting to its (source so) bright, Will from his body ward all blight, And hides the unchanging from men's sight.
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Making myself pure, having understanding I travel on the great Tao. It gives only this fear: The great Tao is exceedingly level But people are pleased with byways. The imperial court taxes to the extreme. The fields are altogether overgrown	If my knowledge were really minute While following great Tao, I' only fear that I might drift from it. Tao is easy to follow. Yet people prefer to stray from it. They keep the halls of	ROBBER BARONS Possessing a modicum of awareness and insight, Follow the straight path of the Tao. A true fear might be in straying. The path, Being so safe and easy - So visibly smooth and straight - Its utter simplicity places it beyond belief. By nature people seem compelled to seek the devious by-paths.	Because I lack importance, I have perception. I walk with the glorious Tao. I dread straying from its path. The path of the great Tao is deceptively smooth and the people are liable to take side paths. Palaces will have excess splendor.	If I were suddenly to become known, and (put into a position to) conduct(a government) according to the Great Tao, what I should be most afraidof would be a boastful display. The great Tao (or way) is very level andeasy; but people love the by-ways.
with weeds. The granaries are completely empty. Clothed in elegant silk Girded with sharp swords Glutted with food and drink Having a surplus of property and money— This is called robbing and boasting [about it]. Besides, it's not the Tao!	authority in splendor, But the fields remain untilled And the granaries stand empty. Clad in fineries, they carry sharp swords. They eat too much and possess to excess. What they do is thievery. Thievery is not Tao.	are the highly visible palaces adorned in splendor, While the fields are left to weed and the granaries stand empty. Wearing elegant clothes, carrying sharp swords, Glutting themselves with food and drink - Possessing more than can be consumed - All this, the province of robber barons, Is far from the true path of the Tao.	Fields will have excess weeds. Granaries will be very empty. People will be dressed in elegant clothes. People will have excessive food and drink. They will have a surplus of wealth and possessions. This is called stealing and exaggeration, not the Tao!	Their court(-yards and buildings) shallbe well kept, but their fields shall be ill-cultivated, and their granariesvery empty. They shall wear elegant and ornamented robes, carry a sharpsword at their girdle, pamper themselves in eating and drinking, and havea superabundance of property and wealth;-such (princes) may be called robbersand boasters. This is contrary to the Tao surely!

That which is well established is not rooted up. That which is well embraced does not slip away. Children and grandchildren, using honorary rites Offer sacrifices unceasingly. Cultivate it in the body—it's virtue shall be Genuineness. Cultivate it in the family—it's virtue shall be [Having] Surplus. Cultivate it in the village—it's virtue shall be Endurance.	What is firmly set up cannot be unsettled. What is firmly embraced cannot slip away. The ancestor worship continues without cease. Practice virtue in your self And your virtue will become genuine. Practice virtue in your family And your virtue will overflow. Practice virtue in your district And your virtue will last long. Practice virtue in your country	CULTIVATING TE Of the Tao: Being well planted, one is not uprooted. Having a firm grasp, one will not slip. Being honored by one's family from generation to generation, Its Te is everlasting. Of the Te: Cultivated in one's self, it becomes genuine. Cultivated in one's family, it becomes abundant. Cultivated in one's community, it will multiply.	If it is well established, it cannot be uprooted. If you skillfully embrace it, it will not leave. For generations, yearly offerings to it have not ceased. Cultivate it in your body. The action of the soul is then real. Cultivate it in the family (clans). The action of the soul is then in surplus. Cultivate it in the village. The action of the soul lasts a	What (Tao's) skilful planter plants can never be uprooted; What his skilful arms enfold, From him can ne'er be borne. Sons shall bring in lengthening line, Sacrifices to his shrine. Tao when nursed within one's self, His vigour will make true; And where the family it rules What riches will accrue! The neighbourhood where it prevails In thriving will abound; And when 'tis seen throughout the state.
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be Abundance. Cultivate it in the world—it's virtue shall be Universality. Therefore: By means of the body, watch the body. By means of the family, watch the family. By means of the village, watch the village. By means of the nation, watch the nation. By means of the world, watch the world.	Practice virtue throughout the world And your virtue will spread wide. So use the individual to judge the individual. Use the family to judge the family. Use the district to judge the district. Use the state to judge the state. Use the world to judge the world. How do I know the way of the world? I do because of what's within me.	Cultivated in the world, it universally pervades All Things. Truly: As is the individual, so the individual is known. As is the family, so the family is known. As is the community, so the community is known. As is the land, so the land is known. As is the world, so the world is known. Thus, from within one's self are All Things known.	long time. Cultivate it in the country. The action of the soul is in abundance. Cultivate it in Heaven below (the sacred body). The action of the soul is universal. The body recognizes the body. The family recognizes the family. The village recognizes the village. The country recognizes the country. Heaven below recognizes Heaven below. How do I perceive Heaven below being so?	Good fortune will be found. Employ it the kingdom over, And men thrive all around. In this way the effect will be seen in the person, by the observation of different cases; in the family; in the neighbourhood; in the state; and in the kingdom. How do I know that this effect is sure to hold thus all under the sky? By this (method of observation).
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Containing the substantiality of virtue Is comparable to [being like] a bare child: Poisonous insects do not sting [you]. Savage beasts do not seize [you]. Snatching birds do not take [you]. [The child's] bones are tender Its muscles are soft. But its grip is firm. It does not yet know the union of female and male And yet it's completely made:	The one who has virtue in its fullness Is like a newborn babe. Hornets and snakes do not sting him. Savage beasts don't attack him. Birds of prey don't pounce on him. His bones are soft and his muscles weak But his grasp is firm. He knows nothing yet of mating But his organ stirs For his vigor is at its height. He will cry all	AS A NEWBORN Possessing Te in abundance, One is as a newborn infant - Protected from the sting of poisonous creatures, Protected from being seized by fierce beasts or mauled by clawing birds. Tho' its bones are tender and muscles weak, Its grip is strong. Not yet knowing the union of male and female, The potential for such union is evident - Its vitality is high. Able to cry aloud all day and	Embody the action of the soul in its fullness. Join with it to be as open as a newborn infant. The bee, scorpion, serpent, and snake, will not bite. Wild animals will not attack. Birds of prey will not strike. Even with weak bones and tender muscles you will be able to stand firm. It does not know male-female union, yet the whole comes into being. The life force is at	He who has in himself abundantly the attributes (of the Tao) is like an infant. Poisonous insects will not sting him; fierce beasts will not seize him; birds of prey will not strike him. (The infant's) bones are weak and its sinews soft, yet its grasp is firm. It knows not yet the union of male and female, and yet its virile member may be excited; - showing the perfection of its physical essence. All day long it will cry without its throat becoming hoarse; - showing the harmony (in its —
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The utmost of vitality indeed! Throughout the day crying and not becoming hoarse: The utmost of harmony indeed! Knowing harmony is called the Constant. Knowing the Constant is called clarity. Promoting life is said to be auspicious. The mind ordering ch'i is said to be violent. A strong thing ruling over what is Old— This is called "non-Tao."	day But his voice will remain loud. For his harmony is at its height. If you know harmony you know what is constant. If you know what is constant you are enlightened. If your mind forces your breath you misuse your strength. You misuse your strength. What expands too much is bound to collapse. This is not the way of Tao.	night and not lose its voice, Truly its natural inner harmony is supreme. Aware of inner harmony, Eternal reality is known. Aware of eternal reality, Insight and enlightenment emerge. However: Constant living at one's peak of activity is to court disaster. Compulsive intellectualization drains energy from the spirit. Such vigor leads to exhaustion and decay and is not the way of the Tao. Being contrary to the Tao, It must - soon perish.	its height! You can cry all day and you are not hoarse. Harmony is at its height! You know that harmony is known as the eternal. You know that the eternal is called the light. The increase in your life force is a blessing. Directing the chi with your mind is violent. Things overdevelop, which is followed by exhaustion. This is not the Tao.	constitution). To him by whom this harmony is known, (The secret of) the unchanging (Tao) is shown, And in the knowledge wisdom finds its throne. All life-increasing arts to evil turn; Where the mind makes the vital breath to burn, (False) is the strength, (and o'er it we should mourn.) When things have become strong, they (then) become old, which may be said to be contrary to the Tao. Whatever is contrary to the Tao soon ends.
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Those who know do not speak. Those who speak do not know. Blunt the sharpness Untie the knots Harmonize the lights Equate the dust— This is called "Mystic Similitude." Therefore: It is not able to be obtained, yet it is near. It is not able to be obtained, and it is	Those who know do not speak. Those who speak do not know. Close the passageways, Lock the entryways, Blunt the sharp edges, Untangle the knots, Dim the bright light, Unite earthly dust. This is called The secret unity. Then there will be no way	PRIMAL AND MYSTICAL UNITY Knowing - thus, not talking. Talking - thus, not knowing. - Quieting speech. - Subduing sensations. - Dulling sharpness. - Releasing entanglements. - Diffusing brightness. - Uniting with the dust of the earth. This is the primal	One who knows, does not speak. One who speaks, does not know. Shut your mouth. Close your gates. Blunt your sharpness. Unravel your tangles. Harmonize your brilliance. Join with your dust. This is called the mystery of the One (the Source). You will not be possessed	He who knows (the Tao) does not (care to) speak (about it); he who is (ever ready to) speak about it does not know it. He (who knows it) will keep his mouth shut and close the portals (of his nostrils).
distant. It is not able to be obtained, yet it benefits. It is not able to be obtained, yet it harms. It is not able to be obtained, yet it is valuable. It is not able to be obtained, yet it is worthless. Therefore, [it] become[s] for the world what is precious.	to like you And no way to dislike you. There'll be no way to assist you And no way to harm you. There'll be no way to honor you And no way to shame you. You'll then obtain the highest prize in the world.	and mystical unity. Possessing this unity, the Sage: Makes no friends or enemies - Is moved by neither love nor hate - Is unaffected by profit or loss, By neither honor nor disgrace. Thus he attains the highest of human states.	by love. You will not be possessed by hate. You will not be possessed by profit. You will not be possessed by loss. You will not be possessed by honor. You will not be possessed by disgrace. This makes Heaven below (the sacred body) a treasure.	He will blunt this sharp points and unravel the complications of things; he will temper his brightness, and bring himself into agreement with the obscurity (of others). This is called 'the Mysterious Agreement.' (Such an one) cannot be treated familiarly of distantly; he is beyond all consideration of profit or injury; of nobility or meanness: - he is the noblest man under heaven.

By uprightness, govern the kingdom. By rarely using soldiers [And] by means of non-administration Take the world. By what means do I know this to be so? By this: The world greatly shuns and avoids [the poor] And the people [remain] completely impoverished. The people greatly sharpen weapons [And] the kingdom and households grow dark. The people [become] excessively crafty and clever [And] strange	To govern the state resort to what's regular. To win a war resort to what's unusual. But to conquer the world refrain from meddling. How do I know of these methods? I do because of what's within me. The fewer the people's freedoms the poorer the people become. The more sharp weapons the people possess, The greater disorder there is in the state. The more diverse	GOVERNMENT With justice and righteousness, Nations are well governed. With cunning strategy, Wars are successfully waged. Through Wu-Wei, All Things are mastered. Intuitively, this is felt: Prohibitions and restrictions being many - Being burdened with ritual avoidance, The people become poorer. Weapons being in abundance, The state increasingly abounds in wars, chaos and disorder. Scheming and cunning artifice being commonplace, Pernicious contrivances are invented -	Connect Heaven and Earth to govern the country. Disconnect Heaven and Earth to use your weapons. By means of not working, you can take hold of Heaven below (the sacred body). I know this to be so! In Heaven below, excess restrictions and prohibitions increase poverty. People have an excess of sharp weapons, the country's families are in great disorder. If people are more skillful at being cunning, more	A state may be ruled by (measures of) correction; weapons of war maybe used with crafty dexterity; (but) the kingdom is made one's own (only)by freedom from action and purpose. How do I know that it is so? By these facts:-In the kingdom the multiplication of prohibitive enactments increases the poverty of the people; the more implements to add to their profit that the people have, the greater disorder is there in the state and clan; the more acts of crafty dexterity that men possess, the more do strange contrivances appear; the more display there is of legislation, the more thieves and robbers there are.
things start [to happen]. Laws and directives are increasingly promulgated [And thus] more robbers and thieves exist. Therefore do the sages say: "I do not administer, and the people change themselves. I am pleased with stillness, and the people correct themselves. I do not [meddle in their] affairs, and the people grow rich by themselves. I do not desire, and the people simplify themselves."	the people's skills, The more unusual things they produce. The more numerous the laws, The more criminals there are. Therefore, the sage says: I take no action, Yet people transform by themselves. I prefer to remain calm, Yet people by themselves become correct. I refrain from meddling, Yet people by themselves begin to prosper. I have no desires,	things happen. Laws, rules, statutes and ordinances being many, Thieves, bandits and dissidents increase and abound. Thus the Sage says: If I do nothing, The people will spontaneously resolve contention. If I love quietude, The people will spontaneously become tranquil, honest and righteous. If I cease interference, The people will spontaneously prosper. If I have no desires, The people will spontaneously return to their original simplicity.	abnormal things arise. Law and order become more and more prominent. Robbers and thieves appear. Thus the sage speaks: I practice not doing (wu wei) and the people naturally transform. I welcome peace and the people naturally create a connection between Heaven and Earth. I do not interfere and the people are naturally wealthy. I am without desires and the people are naturally pure like uncarved wood or uncut jade.	Therefore a sage has said, 'I will do nothing (of purpose), and the people will be transformed of themselves; I will be fond of keeping still, and the people will of themselves become correct. I will take no trouble about it, and the people will of themselves become rich; I will manifest no ambition, and the people will of themselves attain to the primitive simplicity.'

[When] the government is toned down and uninterested The people are honest and unsophisticated. [When] the government is scrutinizing and clinical: The people lack and run short. Misfortune still depends on that which is of good fortune. Good fortune still conceals that which is of misfortune. Who knows the final	When the government is dull and not meddling The people are pure and honest. When the government is shrewd and meddling The people are restless and poor. Good fortune leans on disaster. Disaster lurks in good fate. Is there a way to end this? Is there a norm of what's	CYCLE OF CHANGES When the government governs little, ruling with a light hand, The people are happy and content. When the government governs much, ruling with severity, The people are tense and contentious. A continuing cycle - Misery and calamity, being unsustainable, Are precursors of happiness to come. Likewise happiness, A precursor of misery and calamity.	When the government is dull, dull, the people are pure, pure. When the government is sharp, sharp, the people are broken, broken. Bad fortune! There is good fortune to lean on. Good Fortune! There is bad fortune concealed within it. Who can know the end? There is no normal. The normal, in turn, becomes the abnormal. The good, in turn, becomes evil.	The government that seems the most unwise, Oft goodness to the people best supplies; That which is meddling, touching everything, Will work but ill, and disappointment bring. Misery! -happiness is to be found by its side! Happiness! -misery lurks beneath it! Who knows what either will come in the end? Shall we then dispense with correction?
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end [of this]? [Even] this is not correct. Correctness reverts to being strange. Goodness reverts to being evil. Peoples' bewilderment— Its days certainly have lasted a long time. Therefore, the sages Square but do not cut. Inspect but do not stab. Are straightforward but not unrestrained.	right? What's normal becomes abnormal. What's good becomes evil. With each passing day people grow more confused. That is why the sage is sharp but he does not cut. He burnishes but he does not harm. He straightens but he does not break. He shines but he does not dazzle.	this cycle, For the realization of certainty is itself uncertain. With good turning to evil and evil to good, What is right, what is wrong ? No wonder mankind has been long astray. The Sage, Knowing what is best, is just - Not forcing others to conform. Having integrity, does not injure others. Being straightforward, is gently firm. Emitting light without display, Flows spontaneously toward his destination.	confused and try many paths. The sun is strong and enduring. The sage is square* and the corners do not injure. They have corners and do not pierce. They have truth and do not overreach. They have the light that does not blind. * The square is the planar form of the cube which is the Platonic Solid that represents the energetic structure of Soul Type 4.	The (method of) correction shall by a turn become distortion, and the good in it shall by a turn become evil. The delusion of the people (on this point) has indeed subsisted for a longtime. Therefore the sage is (like) a square which cuts no one (with its angles): (like) a corner which injures no one (with its sharpness). He is straightforward, but allows himself no license; he is bright, but does not dazzle.
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[In] governing the people and serving Heaven There is nothing like thriftiness. Only thriftiness is rightly called "yielding beforehand." Yielding beforehand Entails [one's] arrival at a hard-won accumulation of virtue. [With this] hard-won accumulation of virtue [There is] necessarily nothing not overcome.	While ruling the people And serving heaven Build up a store. If you've built up a store You can adhere to Tao early. If you've adhered to Tao early You can amass virtue. When you've amassed virtue There is nothing you cannot do. When there is nothing you cannot	VITAL ENERGY Establishing a reserve of vital energy, A precious Ch'i - Heaven may be well served. So doing - Permits return to the essence of life, In turn, nourishing and increasing an abundance of Te. Now, Overcoming all difficulty - Gaining infinite	Heaven governs humanity's affairs and resembles the harvest. For this reason the master is frugal and is correct to call for morning clothes. Morning clothes show the importance of accumulating soulful experiences. The important accumulation of soulful experiences emulates emptiness. It does not control. Emptiness that does	For regulating the human (in our constitution) and rendering the (proper)service to the heavenly, there is nothing like moderation. It is only bythis moderation that there is effected and early return (to man's normalstate). That early return is what I call the repeated accumulation of theattributes (of the Tao).
is] necessarily no one who knows your limits. [When] there are none who know your limits [You] can therefore have a kingdom. [When you] have the mother of the kingdom [You] can thereby endure for a long time. This is called "deeply rooted" "A solid foundation." The way of long life and lasting vision.	do Your capacity has no bounds. Having boundless capacity You're ready to rule the realm. Leaning on the mother of the realm You can last through all time. You've been firmly established. You have a strong support. This is the Tao of long life. This is the Tao of farsightedness.	capacity - Being beyond all limitations - Suitability for leading and serving nations is achieved. Holding to the Tao, the government of nations may endure. Having a firm foundation, Deeply rooted, abundantly strong, The Tao of long life and durable vision is achieved.	not control follows no one. Experiencing this is the highest. Not experiencing this causes the emergence of rulers, the emergence of kingdoms. The mother is able to long endure which shows a deep foundation. The strengthened foundation increases life and brings an enduring recognition of the Tao.	With that repeated accumulation of those attributes,there comes the subjugation we know not what shall be the limit; and whenone knows not what the limit shall be, he may be the ruler of a state.He who possesses the mother of the state may continue long. His case islike that (of the plant) of which we say that its roots are deep and itsflower stalks firm; -this is the way to secure that its enduring life shalllong be seen.

Governing a great kingdom is like quick-frying small delicacies. [When] using the Tao to manage the world Its demons are powerless. [It's] not [exactly] that its demons are powerless [But that] their powers do not	Rule a big country The way you'd cook a small fish. If Tao is used to govern the world Evil spirits have no power. Their power is not gone But it	GENTLENESS Rule and govern All Things with gentleness, In harmony with the Tao. Thus does the power of evil spirits remain unfulfilled -	Govern a great state as carefully as you would fry a small fish. The Tao can govern Heaven below (the sacred body). You are lost in a field without direction when you are not with your soul. Surely being lost in a field without direction happens when you are not with your	Governing a great state is like cooking small fish. Let the kingdom be governed according to the Tao, and the manes of the departed will not manifest their spiritual energy. It is not that those manes have not that spiritual energy, but it will not be employed to hurt men.
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harm people. Not [only is it] that their powers do not harm people [But] the sages also do not harm people. Both do not reciprocate harm. This is the reason [their] virtues mix and thereupon return.	does not harm the people. Their power does not harm the people And it does not harm the sage. As they suffer no harm Their virtues unite and return to them.	Neither does the good spirit of the Sage cause harm. The Sage himself, being likewise protected, Unity and perfect harmony prevail for all.	soul. The soul does not enter the people like an arrow. The soul surely does not enter the people like an arrow. The sage does not enter the people like an arrow. Both together will not enter the people like an arrow. The action of the soul unifies and restores the path, indeed.	It is not that it could not hurt men, but neither does the ruling sage hurt them. When these two do not injuriously affect each other, their good influences converge in the virtue (of the Tao).
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That kingdom that is great Is modest and flowing: The intersection of the world. The female of the world. The female, always by means of gentleness, overcomes the male. Therefore, [being] gentle is being modest. Therefore: The great kingdom, by means of modesty [toward] the small kingdom Receives the small kingdom.	A big country is like a low-lying land. It's like the meeting ground of the world. It's like the female of the world. The female always defeats the male with calmness. Because she is calm, she remains low. Thus if the big country is below the small country It conquers the small country. And if the small country is below	THE YIELDING NATION A great nation, like a river delta, Receives the riches of the land. In being receptive - possessing the Yin, Receiving the Yang unto it, Overcomes all by its very peacefulness and quietude. So - A great nation, placing itself below a lesser, Absorbs the lesser. A lesser nation, submitting to	A great state lies below the river and unites with Heaven below (the sacred body). Heaven below is female. The female is eternal and tranquil which sustains the male. Through peacefulness and acting below, a great country has the means to receive a petty country. Thus they can govern a petty country. By means of	What makes a great state is its being (like) a low-lying, down-flowing(stream);-it becomes the centre to which tend (all the small states) underheaven. (To illustrate from) the case of all females:-the female alwaysovercomes the male by her stillness. Stillness may be considered (a sortof) abasement. Thus it is that a great state, by condescending to smallstates, gains them for itself; and that small states, by abasing themselves to a great state, win it over to them.
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Receives the great kingdom. Therefore: Some are modest in order to receive. Some are modest and are received. The great kingdom does not inordinately desire To annex livestock and people. The small kingdom does not inordinately desire To come into the service of people. [So that] they both get what each one desires That which is the great [kingdom] should become modest.	the big country It conquers the big country. Thus some win by becoming low And some win by remaining low. What the big country wants Is to unite people and nourish them. What the small country wants Is to serve people and find shelter for them. Both can get what they want If it's the big country that becomes low.	a greater, Conquers and wins adherence of the greater. Thus - To absorb, conquer and win adherence, - One must yield. Truly - Those who triumph, do so by yielding. A great nation prospers by absorbing, A lesser by joining and participating. For both to so benefit,	being below, a great country thus governs itself. The capacity to be below is the means to govern. A great country's tendency is to unite and nourish the people. A petty country's tendency is to penetrate the people's activities. Above all, they both have a tendency. For the great it is proper to act below.	In the one case the abasement leadsto gaining adherents, in the other case to procuring favour. The greatstate only wishes to unite men together and nourish them; a small stateonly wishes to be received by, and to serve, the other. Each gets whatis desires, but the great state must learn to abase itself.
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That which the Tao is: A deep obscurity among the ten-thousand things. The treasure of kind people. The sanctuary of unkind people. Flattering speech can be used to buy and sell honor. Flattering deeds can be used to increase [the position of] people. The unkind among people— Why abandon them to Existence? Therefore, [when] establishing the emperor	Tao is the source of the myriad things. It is the treasure of those who are good. It is the refuge of those who are bad. Fine words can buy honor. Fine deeds can serve as a gift. Why reject those who are bad? So when the emperor is installed, And his ministers appointed,	THE TREASURED TAO The Tao, being the source and pivotal support of All Things, Is a treasure to the virtuous, a refuge for the unworthy. Fine words, being worthy of honor, Noble deeds, deserving of respect, Even the evil and unworthy are not forsaken by the Tao. Thus now, as	The ten-thousand things (everything) follow the Tao. Its mystery is the good person's treasure. It protects the bad person. Pleasing words can be used to sell. Honorable actions bring people together. Why reject the essence of people who are not good? The emperor who appoints three ministers to bring precious jade preceded by	Tao has of all things the most honoured place. No treasures give goodmen so rich a grace; Bad men it guards, and doth their ill efface. (Its) admirable words can purchase honour; (its) admirable deeds canraise their performer above others. Even men who are not good are not abandonedby it.
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though there are salutations [made] And [so many] jade-wares [that it takes] An advancing team of four horses [to present them] [Even this is] not as good as sitting down And offering this Tao. Those from of old who considered this Tao to be valuable— Why [did they do so]? [Is it] not said: "The seeking thereby attain; The guilty are thereby delivered from evil"?	Do not offer them precious stones and horses But remain calm, offer the Tao. Why did the ancients pay tribute to Tao? Did they not use to say: "Those who seek get what they seek thanks to Tao. Thanks to Tao the offenders are saved"? That is why Tao is the treasure to the world.	in ancient days, Upon coronations and important appointments of state, A better gift than worldly things, Is the quiet offering of the Tao. The Tao, so prized from antiquity to this day, Rewarding those spontaneously seeking it, Freeing the spirit of evil ones, Is of All Things, most highly treasured.	a team of four horses is not equal to the stillness of advancing the Tao. We honor the Tao because it came first. Does it not say that those who seek to attain reality can thus free themselves from wrongdoing? Thus the act of becoming human is Heaven below's (the sacred body's) treasure.	Therefore when the sovereign occupies his place as the Son of Heaven, and he has appointed his three ducal ministers though (a prince) were to send in a round symbol-of-rank large enough to fill both the hands, and that as the precursor of the team of horses (in the court-yard), such an offering would not be equal to (a lesson of) this Tao, which one might present on his knees. Why was it that the ancients prized this Tao so much? Was it not because it could be got by seeking for it, and the guilty could escape (from the stain of their guilt) by it? This is the reason why all under heaven consider it the most valuable thing.
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Do [things] without "doing" [them]. Work without working. Taste without tasting. [Make] the great small [And] the many few. Respond to adversity with [this] virtue. Seek the difficult through the easy. Manage the great through the minute. Difficult matters in the world must be done through the easy ones.	Act without taking action. Be busy without busy-ness. Taste what cannot be tasted. Magnify the small Multiply the few. Repay injury with kindness. Prepare for the difficult while it is still easy. Work on the big thing while it is still small. The difficult things of the world are initially easy. The big things of	THE DIFFICULT AND THE EASY Practicing Wu-Wei, - Act without acting. - Work without doing. - Taste without tasting. Small becomes great, few becomes many, The unkind is rewarded with kindness. Let simplicity emerge from complication. Dealing with trouble while still mere bother, Resolution emerges from potential difficulty.	Act without doing (wu wei). Work without working. Taste without tasting. Great is small, more is less. Respond to hatred with the action of your soul. Deal with the difficult by becoming one (with the source). Easily become great through the exquisite. The difficult endeavors of Heaven below (the sacred body) flourish through ease.	(It is the way of the Tao) to act without (thinking of) acting; to conduct affairs without (feeling the) trouble of them; to taste without discerning any flavour; to consider what is small as great, and a few as many; and to recompense injury with kindness. (The master of it) anticipates things that are difficult while they are easy, and does things that would become great while they are small.
Thus, the sages at no time do great [things]. This is the reason they can achieve the great [things]. Those who make frivolous promises are certainly bereft of sincerity. Too much ease most certainly [results in] too much difficulty. Therefore do the sages [Treat things] as though they [were] difficult	the world are initially small. The sage does not strive to achieve great things So he is able achieve greatness. Those who are quick to make promises Are bound not to be trusted. What may seem easy Is bound to become hard. The sage accepts his tasks as difficult. Therefore they all become easy for him.	dealing effectively with great problems, Requires attention before those problems achieve great magnitude. Thus the Sage, by never dealing with problems of great magnitude, Achieves greatness. Glib promises can rarely be kept. Ostensibly easy accomplishment rarely lacks difficulty of performance. The Sage, ever mindful of difficulty, Encounters no difficulty.	Heaven below's great endeavors arise from the exquisite. Until their last day, the sage does not act great, hence can accomplish great things. To condemn the inarticulate diminishes trust. Changing places (becoming one with) becomes very difficult. By means of resembling the difficulty, the sage is free of difficulty until the end of their days.	All difficult things in the world are sure to arise from a previous state in which they were easy, and all great things from one in which they were small. Therefore the sage, while he never does what is great, is able on that account to accomplish the greatest things. He who lightly promises is sure to keep but little faith; he who is continually thinking things easy is sure to find them difficult. Therefore the sage sees difficulty even in what seems easy, and so never has any difficulties.

The stabilized is easy to grasp. The not-yet-begun is easy to plan for. The brittle is easy to break. The tiny is easy to scatter. Act upon it while it does not yet exist. Govern it while it is not yet chaotic. The tree [as thick as] joined arms embraced Comes into existence at an insignificant height. The platform of nine stories is built by piling up dirt. The journey of a thousand miles begins with a [single] step. Those who contrive, ruin them. Those who grasp, lose them. Therefore, the sages Do not contrive and	What is at rest is easy to hold. What has not yet begun is easy to stop. That which is flimsy is easy to shatter. That which is tiny is easy to scatter. Confront the events before they begin. Set things in order before there is trouble. A tree bigger than a grown man's embrace Was once a tiny sprout. A tower nine stories high Was built on a lump of dirt. A journey of a thousand miles Begins right under your feet. It's those who take action that fail. It's those who hold	OVERT ACTION Remaining still, it is easy to hold. Unmanifest and unforetold, there are no limits for the making of plans. Being brittle, it is easy to shatter. Being small, it is easy to disperse. Deal then with formative troubles before catastrophic events occur - Create order before confusion can begin. Truly - The giant tree begins as a tiny sprout. The high tower begins as a heap of earth. The long journey begins as a single step from where one stands. Overt acting causes harm and failure. Overt grasping causes loss.	That which is content is easy to hold. That which does not manifest easily is a scheme. That which is delicate is easy to dissolve. That which is mysterious is easy to disperse. Practice and do not possess. Govern through not creating discord. Join and embrace a tree as it grows from a tiny seedling. A tower of nine stories rises from the Earth. A thousand li* journey begins when you are sufficiently connected to the Earth. Those who do, destroy. Those who seize, lose. The sages	That which is at rest is easily kept hold of; before a thing has given indications of its presence, it is easy to take measures against it; that which is brittle is easily broken; that which is very small is easily dispersed. Action should be taken before a thing has made its appearance; order should be secured before disorder has begun. The tree which fills the arms grew from the tiniest sprout; the tower of nine storeys rose from a (small) heap of earth; the journey of a thousand li commenced with a single step. He who acts (with an ulterior purpose) does harm; he who takes hold of a thing (in the same way) loses his hold.
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therefore do not ruin.	on to things that lose them.	—	practice not doing (wu wei) and do not destroy.	(But) people in their conduct of affairs are constantly ruining them when they are on the eve of success. If they were careful at the end, as (they should be) at the beginning, they would not so ruin them.
Do not grasp and therefore do not lose.	Therefore the sage takes no action,	—	They do not seize and they do not lose.	Therefore the sage desires what (other men) do not desire, and does not prize things difficult to get; he learns what (other men) do not learn, and turns back to what the multitude of men have passed by.
The undertakings of the people:	And so he does not fail.	—	The people pursue their worldly affairs, and are often near success, and yet they fail.	Thus he helps the natural development of all things, and does not dare to act (with an ulterior purpose of his own).
[They see] matters frequently [through] to near-completion	He doesn't hold on to things,	—	When they are as careful to the end as they are in the beginning they will not fail in their worldly affairs.	
But ruin them [toward the end].	And so he doesn't lose them.	—	The sages desires are not deep-seated desires.	
Act with care in the end just as in the beginning	People always fail when their work is nearly done.	—	They do not value difficult-to-obtain treasures.	
[And you] will not ruin the matter.	So be cautious when you start	—	They study not studying.	
Therefore, the sages	And be cautious when you finish.	—	They can help ten-thousand things (everything) naturally and do not venture to act.	
Desire not to desire	That is why the sage desires not to desire	—	* Li=1/3 mile	
And do not value goods that are hard to get.	And does not value rare things.	—		
Learning "un-learning"	He learns what cannot be learnt	—		
They return to the place the masses of people have [all] passed by.	And returns to what others pass by.	—		
Therefore, they assist the true natures of the ten-thousand things	He could help the myriad things	—		
And do not dare to contrive.	Follow their true nature	—		
	Yet he dares not do it.	—		
		—		

Those of old who were good at governing [with] the Tao Did not thereby enlighten the people. [That] would thereby cheat them. The difficulty of people to govern Is because of their excessive cleverness. Therefore, to use cleverness to govern the kingdom Is [to be] a thief to the kingdom. Not to use	The ancients who excelled at following Tao Did not enlighten people But kept them free from cleverness. If people are too clever they are difficult to rule. To rule the state with cleverness Is to rob the state; But to rule the	ESTABLISHING HARMONY The ancient Sages, knowing the natural Tao, Refrained from schooling others in intellectual enlightenment. Calculative thinking and strict intellectual processes were discouraged, For people were argumentative and difficult to lead when so schooled. Leading - Through intellect alone - harmful to all, Through encouraging the simple and natural intuitive part of	The ancients were excellent in the practice of the Tao. It was surely not only because they were of the light, but because they were able to receive the people's folly. People are difficult to govern because of their extreme cunning. Therefore cunning governs the rulers of the country. They are thieves. When cunning	The ancients who showed their skill in practising the Tao did so, not to enlighten the people, but rather to make them simple and ignorant. The difficulty in governing the people arises from their having much knowledge. He who (tries to) govern a state by his wisdom is a scourge to it; while he who does not (try to) do so is a blessing.
cleverness to govern the kingdom Is [to be] a blessing to the kingdom. Those who understand these both Also examine the System. Always understanding and examining the System Is called Mystic Virtue. Mystic Virtue is mysterious! Profound! It grants counter-intuitive things! Then [you] are truly indeed	state without cleverness Is to benefit the state. These are the two forms of rulership. To remain aware of them is to have the secret virtue. The secret virtue reaches far and touches all. It leads all things back to the great accord.	mankind - a blessing to all. Understanding the difference between these, A test and a standard exists. Being able to apply this test and standard, Is a profoundly mysterious virtue. This Te, Being deep, penetrating and far reaching - All Things return to their natural state, Bringing the original complete harmony to all.	does not govern the rulers of the country, there is good fortune. Recognize both of these. Always pay attention to the way the master speaks of the mysterious action of the soul. The mysterious action of the soul is deep! Distant! Join with its substance and return! After this great harmony is at its height.	He who knows these two things finds in them also his model and rule. Ability to know this model and rule constitutes what we call the mysterious excellence (of a governor). Deep and far reaching is such mysterious excellence, showing indeed its possessor as opposite to others, but leading them to a great conformity to him.

Those who are [in] the position where the large rivers [meet] the sea Can thereby become the king of the hundred mountain streams. Because they are skilled at humbling themselves Is the reason they can become the king of the hundred mountain streams. Therefore, the sages Wishing to be above people Must [do so] by means of speaking humbly to them.	How can rivers and oceans be king of one hundred valleys? They excel in staying below them. That is why they can become their king. Thus if the sage wishes to be the people's master He has to talk to them like their servant. If he wishes to lead them He	HUMILITY How much greater are the oceans and seas Than the many lesser streams they rule. The grand oceans and seas - Obtaining their greatness and dominion, by being lower, Receive thereby, the homage of hundreds of streams. The Sage, In order to be over people to guide them, Places	Great rivers and seas can rule the hundred valleys because they are positioned below to receive the water. In this way, they rule the hundred valleys. The people are positive that their deep-seated desires are of the highest nature and justify them with inferior speech. Deep-seated desires began for people when the body was put second. There is a reason the sages do not	That whereby the rivers and seas are able to receive the homage and tribute of all the valley streams, is their skill in being lower than they;-itis thus that they are the kings of them all. So it is that the sage, wishing to be above men, puts himself by his words below them, and wishing to be before them, places his person behind them.
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Must [do so] by means of [placing] themselves behind them. Therefore, the sages Are placed on top, and the people are not burdened. Placed in front, and the people are not harmed. Therefore, the world is glad to push [them] forward And does not get tired [of them]. Because they do not contend Is the reason no one in the world	has to follow behind them. This way he can be their master Without oppressing them. He can precede them Without blocking their way. That is why the whole world is willing to praise him And never tires of doing so. He contends with no one, So no one can contend with him.	himself beneath them, serving them with humility. In order to lead them, Must follow behind them. Accordingly, the Sage is truly over people, Leading them without oppressing them. Standing before them, protects them from harm. All people, tirelessly lending him support, Follow him. Not competing with anyone,	engage with or give weight to the people's deep-seated desires. They stop in front of the deep-seated desires and the people do not suffer (from their own deep-seated desires). This is because Heaven below (the sacred body) is joyfully supported and not beyond its limits. Accordingly it does not compete. Therefore, Heaven below is without the ability to join with the deep-seated desires and compete.	In this way though he has his place above them, men do not feel his weight, nor though he has his place before them, do they feel it an injury to them. Therefore all in the world delight to exalt him and do not weary of him. Because he does not strive, no one finds it possible to strive with him.
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Everyone in the world calls my Tao "great"

As if nothing resembled it.

Precisely because it is great

Is the reason it seems that nothing resembles it.

Supposing it resembled [something]—

Long-standing indeed its pettiness would be [for] man!

I have three treasures.

Keep and protect them.

The first is called "motherly love"

The second is called "meagerness"

The third is called "not daring to be foremost in the world."

Motherly love is the reason I can be

The whole world says:

"What you teach is great yet unlike anything else."

It is its greatness that makes it unlike anything else.

Were it like everything else

It would have become trivial a long time ago.

I have three treasures which I hold and keep safe.

The first is compassion.

The second economy.

The third not daring to take the lead.

If you're compassionate you can be fearless.

If you're not wasteful

THE THREE TREASURES

While being recognized and proclaimed as great by consensus of all people,

Yet the Tao is indescribable.

Being indescribable by common standards,

It is great.

Were it so describable,

Its greatness would have long ago vanished.

From it, three great treasures are possessed,

To be embraced, guarded and kept secure.

The first is Tzu,

Characterized by gentleness, compassion, mercy and nurturing love.

The second, Chien,

By renunciation, frugality and economy which limits possession to no more than that which is truly needed.

When

All people of Heaven below (the sacred body) call the Tao great because it does not resemble anything.

The masters are great because they do not resemble anything.

The Tao is barely visible.

It endures!

It is exquisite!

The master says, "I have three treasures. I hold and protect them."

One is called compassion.

Two is called moderation.

Three is known as not presuming to venture ahead of Heaven below.

Compassion gives you the power

All the world says that, while my Tao is great, it yet appears to be inferior (to other systems of teaching). Now it is just its greatness that makes it seem to be inferior. If it were like any other (system), for long would its smallness have been known! But I have three precious things which I prize and hold fast. The first is gentleness; the second is economy; and the third is shrinking from taking precedence of others.

brave.

Meagerness is the reason I can be expansive.

Not daring to be foremost in the world

Is the reason I can achieve magnanimous leadership.

To desist today from motherly love and so also bravery

From meagerness and so also expansiveness

From being behind and so also being in front—

Is Death indeed.

Those fighting by means of motherly love

Are necessarily victorious

Because [their] defense is completely solid.

Heaven will help them

And

With motherly love

Protect them.

you can be giving.

If you're afraid to lead you can attain the highest honors.

Today people renounce compassion and try to be brave.

They are wasteful in extreme and try to be giving.

They refuse to be follow and they try to take the lead.

They are certainly doomed.

Compassion gives you victory in battle

And strength in defense.

When heaven comes to your rescue

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to be courageous.

Moderation gives you the power to be generous.

Not presuming to venture ahead of Heaven below gives you the power to succeed in expanding your vessel (body).

Nowadays people:

- forsake compassion to be daring.

- forsake moderation to be abundant.

- forsake, postpone, and soon die!

Through compassion the master can fight to overcome.

By holding firm to this, heaven takes them in hand and takes care of them.

Compassion protects them.

With that gentleness I can be bold; with that economy I can be liberal; shrinking from taking precedence of others, I can become a vessel of the highest honour.

Now-a-days they give up gentleness and are all for being bold; economy, and are all for being liberal; the hindmost place, and seek only to be foremost;—(of all which the end is) death. Gentleness is sure to be victorious even in battle, and firmly to maintain its ground. Heaven will save its possessor, by his (very) gentleness protecting him.

Those who are skilled at being warriors are not warlike. Those who are skilled at fighting are not angry. Those who are skilled at overcoming enemies do not engage [them]. Those who are	The best soldier is not violent. The best fighter does not fly into rage. The best winner does not engage the opponent. The best employer does	NON - CONTENTION The greatest warrior shuns the violence of war. The greatest fighter shuns the display of anger. The greatest conqueror shuns overt competition. The greatest	The good actions of the masters* are not warlike or aggressive. A skillful battle does not include anger. To skillfully defeat an enemy, do not join them in their anger. Employ	He who in (Tao's) wars has skill Assumes no martial port; He who fights with most good will To rage makes no resort. He who vanquishes yet still Keeps from his foes apart; He whose hests men most fulfil Yet humbly plies his art.
skilled at managing people act humbly toward them. This is called the virtue of non-contention. This is called the power of managing people. This is called merging with Heaven, the Oldest of Old.	not put himself above others. This is the virtue of non-contending. This is the ability of managing people. This is the finest way of matching heaven.	leader is humble with his people. Thus is the power of non-contention. Thus is the capacity to utilize people well. Thus is the ancient ultimate unity with heaven.	people well by staying below them. The action of the soul is called employing people's strengths. This is called complying with Heaven's ancient perfection. * The person who knows all from 1-10.	Thus we say, 'He ne'er contends, And therein is his might.' Thus we say, 'Men's wills he bends, That they with him unite.' Thus we say, 'Like Heaven's his ends, No sage of old more bright.' [Note: hests are commands, orders.]

[About] using soldiers, there exists a saying: "We dare not act as lords but rather as guests. [We] do not dare to advance an inch but rather retreat a foot." This is called Prevailing without prevailing Repelling without an arm Throwing [them] out	Experts in warfare have a saying: "I dare not launch an attack. I'd rather mount a defense. I dare not advance a foot, I'd rather retreat a mile." This is called: Moving forward without moving forward. Removing the sleeves without baring the arms. Being armed without holding	THE COMPASSIONATE WARRIOR Among great warriors, it is spoken: It is more propitious to be the defender than the aggressor. Better to retreat a foot than advance an inch. This is known as: Marching without the appearance of moving. Preparing for conflict without the appearance of arming.	From using force a saying emerges: I dare not act like a ruler, but instead I must act like a guest. Do not venture an inch when you can withdraw a foot. This is called progress without progressing. Seize without seizing.	A master of the art of war has said, 'I do not dare to be the host(to commence the war); I prefer to be the guest (to act on the defensive).I do not dare to advance an inch; I prefer to retire a foot.' This is calledmarshalling the ranks where there are no ranks; baring the arms (to fight)where there are no arms to bare; grasping the weapon where there is nowapon to grasp: advancing against the enemy where there is no enemy.
without resisting [them] Holding [them] without a fight. There is no misfortune greater than trivializing an enemy. [If we] trivialize an enemy, how many funerals [will be] our "reward"? Therefore [When] opposing armies clash with each Those who mourn are in fact the winners.	a weapon. Seizing the enemy without confronting him. There is no worse disaster than to have no enemy. If I have no enemy my treasure is as good as lost. Thus when the battle begins And the opponents are evenly matched It is the grieving side that wins.	foe without the appearance of attack. To engage in war lightly - To underestimate the foe, These are catastrophes as severe as the loss of one's treasures - Those abilities for compassion, renunciation and the rejection of preeminence. Thus, when a battle is joined, Victory is achieved by the compassionate warrior,	Apply force to no opponent. Manage without weapons. There is no greater calamity than disregarding the enemy. Disregarding your enemy brings you close to the death of what you treasure. When two armies meet and inspect each other, grieve for the winner!	Thereis no calamity greater than lightly engaging in war. To do that is nearlosing (the gentleness) which is so precious. Thus it is that when opposingweapons are (actually) crossed, he who deplores (the situation) conquers.

My words are very easy to understand.

Very easy to practice.

There are none in the world who can understand [them].

None who can practice [them].

Words have an ancestor.

Affairs have a sovereign.

Precisely because one does

My words are easy to understand

And it is easy to follow them.

Yet they can be grasped by no one in the world

And there is no one who can follow them.

My words are of an ancient

YOU KNOW ME NOT

Being very easy to comprehend,

These teachings are simple to practice.

Yet, few are they who will release ego sufficiently to achieve understanding,

let alone the ability to practice.

These teachings have their source in nature,

Their master is the

Their sayings are very easy to know and very easy to practice in Heaven below (the sacred body).

Without the power to perceive, without the power to progress;

Speech arises from your past.

Deeds

My words are very easy to know, and very easy to practise; but there is no one in the world who is able to know and able to practise them.

There is an originating and all-comprehending (principle) in my words, and an authoritative law for the things (which I enforce).

not understand [this]

Is the reason one does not understand me.

Those who understand me are rare.

Those who follow me are prized.

Therefore, the sages

Are covered in coarse cloth

[But carry in their] bosoms a jewel.

origin.

My actions are guided by reason.

Yet this remains unknown,

So I remain unknown, too.

Those who know me are few

This is what honors me.

The sage wears plain clothing.

His true wealth is concealed in his heart.

Tao.

Not comprehending this,

People find great difficulty in understanding the Sage.

So, with few people really understanding him,

He is most highly valued.

Thus the Sage,

Tho' presenting a poor appearance, to the world,

Yet carries the riches of nature embedded in his core.

are exalted.

For this exact reason the master knows emptiness.

This is the reason they are not recognized.

Know their soundlessness.

Emulate them.

Treasure the sage who wears coarse clothes and hides their jewels.

It is because they do not know these, that men do not know me. They who know me are few, and I am on that account-(the more) to be prized. It is thus that the sage wears (a poor garb of) hair cloth, while he carries his (signet of) jade in his bosom.

Knowing "no-knowing" is best. Not to know [this] "knowing" is a fault. Only those who take faults to be faults Are therefore without fault.	If you know that you're ignorant you are fine. If you don't know that you're ignorant you are flawed. Only when	STRENGTH IN KNOWLEDGE Knowing you know not, is strength - A high attainment. Not knowing, yet thinking you know, is sickness - A dire defect. Only with knowledge of this	Know not knowing. Those above do not know knowing. For this reason they are sick. Sickness, use your sickness as the means	To know and yet (think) we do not know is the highest (attainment);not to know (and yet think) we do know is a disease.
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The sages are without fault For they take faults to be faults. Only those who take faults to be faults Are therefore without fault.	you recognize your flaws Will you become flawless. The sage is free from flaws. He's flawless because he knows his flaws.	sickness as a sickness, Can the defect be removed. The Sage has no sickness - no defect. Recognizing sickness as sickness, defect as defect, He is free from these curses.	to get well. The sage is not sick, because they use the one. Sickness, use your sickness as the means to get well.	It is simply by beingpained at (the thought of) having this disease that we are preserved fromit. The sage has not the disease. He knows the pain that would be inseparablefrom it, and therefore he does not have it.
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The people do not fear might That imitates the Great Might to the extreme. Do not disrespect their dwelling places. Do not hate their homelands. It is only because one does not	When people have no fear of what they should fear. Something really fearsome will come on them. Do not constrict their living space. Do not reduce their means of livelihood. If they're not pestered	RECOGNITION OF ATTRIBUTES Be not irate should others fail to be awed by your attributes. Having true importance, circumstances will ultimately bring proper recognition. Imprison them not - Harass and oppress them not, Treating them	When people are not afraid of the power of the Tao then the great power will be at its height. The vessel (body) will not be restricted. Inhabit a vessel free of restrictions. It gives life. For this exact reason the masters do not go beyond their limits.	When the people do not fear what they ought to fear, that which is their great dread will come on them. Let them not thoughtlessly indulge themselves in their ordinary life; let them not act as if weary of what that life depends on.
hate That one is therefore not hated. Therefore, the sages Know themselves but do not display themselves. Are kind to themselves but do not prize themselves. Thus, leave that and take up this.	they will not get weary. Therefore the sage knows himself But does not flaunt himself. He loves himself But does not exalt himself. He chooses what truly has value, Spurns what only seems that way.	compassionately, You, in turn, will be so treated. Thus the Sage, Knowing his own power, Does not overtly display it. Loving himself, Does not exalt himself. Rejecting external sensuousness, He accepts the powers within his being.	They do not go beyond their limits. The sage naturally perceives and does not have opinions. They naturally express humanity in their actions and do not give preference to themselves. They are able to discard giving preference to themselves and take hold of expressing humanity in their actions.	It is by avoiding such indulgence that such weariness does not arise. Therefore the sage knows (these things) of himself, but does not parade (his knowledge); loves, but does not (appear to set a) value on, himself. And thus he puts the latter alternative away and makes choice of the former.

The fearless in daring are necessarily killed. The fearless in not-daring necessarily survive. Those who are of these two [types]: Some are benefited. Some are harmed. That which is detested by Heaven—who knows the reason? The Tao of Heaven does	The one whose courage comes from being fearless Gets killed. The one whose courage comes from being fearful Stays alive. Both kinds of bravery lead to benefit or harm. If one of them heaven detests who knows the reason why? Even the sage is unable	COURAGE That courage which is manifest by bravado and foolhardiness, Leads to disaster and death. That which is not so manifest, Leads to life. Between these two, One benefits - one does not. Even the Sage has difficulty in knowing why one of these brings destruction from above. It is the way of nature	Being rash in your courage is like killing. Not being rash in your courage supports life. Of these two, one supports Heaven, the other does not. People who are in an ugly-hearted place, what do they know? The sages are correct to watch for this difficulty. Heaven's	He whose boldness appears in his daring (to do wrong, in defiance of the laws) is put to death; he whose boldness appears in this not daring (to do so) lives on. Of these two cases the one appears to be advantageous, and the other to be injurious. but When Heaven's anger smites a man, Who the cause shall truly scan? On this account the sage feels a difficulty (as to what to do in the former case).
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not struggle but is good at winning. Does not speak but is good at responding. Is not summoned but returns of itself. Is simple like this but is good at planning. Heaven's net is immensely vast. Lax. But nothing slips through.	to explain this. The Tao of heaven excels at overcoming without competing, At responding without speaking, At drawing to itself without beckoning, At laying plans without hurrying. Heaven's weapons are crude, its targets strewn wide Yet when it takes aim it won't miss the mark.	- - Not to compete, yet to achieve victory. - Not to ask, yet to obtain an answer. - Not to summon, yet to be supplied all needs. - Not to overtly plan, yet to achieve results. Truly - the net of nature is cast far and wide. Tho' its mesh be coarse, Yet nothing escapes.	Tao: - does not compete and excels at overcoming. - does not use words and has good answers. - does not summon yet spontaneously attracts. - has a patient manner, yet is good at laying plans. Heaven's net is vast, wide, and open, and nothing is lost.	It is the way of Heaven not to strive, and yet it skillfully overcomes; not to speak, and yet it is skilful in (obtaining) a reply, does not call, and yet men come to it of themselves. Its demonstrations are quiet, and yet its plans are skilful and effective. The meshes of the net of Heaven are large; far apart, but letting nothing escape.
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People do not fear death [But] how can [one possibly] endure [If one] uses death to frighten them? Suppose the people are made ever to fear death And that those who act out of the ordinary I seize, detain, and kill. Who would dare [to	If people have no fear of death It's pointless to threaten them with it. If people were in constant fear of death, And if anyone acting deviously Were to be seized and executed, Who would dare to do so? The Master	PENALTY OF DEATH Should the people have no fear of death, Threatening them with such a penalty, Is the essence of futility. Should the people fear death, Be there any among them who would commit a crime, Knowing death to be the penalty ? Who then, is comfortable as the executioner	If people are not afraid to die, why would you use death to threaten them? If you make people constantly fear death, and seize the dishonest ones and kill them, who would dare to do the killing? An	The people do not fear death; to what purpose is it to (try to) frighten them with death? If the people were always in awe of death, and I could always seize those who do wrong, and put them to death, who would dare to do wrong?
do this]? Frequently, there those chief executioners who are killed. Those who take the place of the chief executioners are [also] killed. This is called usurping the Master Carpenter. [Among] those who usurp the Master Carpenter There are few who do not cut their hands.	Executioner is always there to kill. If you attempt to play his role It is like trying to do the work of a master lumberjack. The one who has no skill to do this work Seldom escapes with his hands unhurt.	? Is not nature the wisest judge regarding timeliness for one to die ? To otherwise kill in defiance of nature is to be as an apprentice carpenter performing complicated hewing for his master. In performing a task unsuited to his natural level of skill, He is certain to be injured.	official would do the killing. The one who kills is like the person who takes the place of the great artisan who created the universe. Whomever takes the place of this great artisan rarely escapes injuring their own hand!	There is always One who presides over the infliction of death. He who would inflict death in the room of him who so presides over it maybe described as hewing wood instead of a great carpenter. Seldom is it that who undertakes the hewing, instead of the great carpenter, does not cut his own hands!

The people's starving Is because of their superior's consumption of too many taxes. Thus the starvation. The people's difficulty to govern Is because of their superior's possessive governing. Thus the difficulty to	Why are the people starving? Because those above them put heavy taxes on them And eat up their grain. That's why the people are starving. Why are the people difficult to rule? Because those above them are meddlesome. That's why the	VALUE OF LIVING LIFE People are starved of body, When the government taxes to excess. People are starved of spirit and become unruly, When the government, by over-control, interferes with the natural rights of	The people are starving because those who come from above are consuming their tax grain. Their consumption is the reason for starvation. The people find this way of ruling difficult because it comes from above. It is radiance around death that	The people suffer from famine because of the multitude of taxes consumed by their superiors. It is through this that they suffer famine. The people are difficult to govern because of the (excessive) agency of their superiors (in governing them).
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govern. The people's reckless deaths Are because of their seeking the thickness of life. Thus the reckless deaths. Only those who do not use life to contrive Are indeed skilled at valuing life.	people are difficult to rule. Why are the people are unconcerned about death? Because those above them care too much about life. That's why the people are unconcerned about death. It is better to disregard life Than to exalt it too much.	mankind. Being so starved of both body and spirit, Their leaders demanding so much of living life, Little remains upon which to live. People know better than to place too much value upon life.	enables you to pursue coming forth. Generosity is the basis for your radiance around death. For the reason of not having a reason, the master comes forth in life. The act of becoming is worthy through the exalted act of coming forth.	It is through this that they are difficult to govern. The people make light of dying because of the greatness of their labours in seeking for the means of living. It is this which makes them think light of dying. Thus it is that to leave the subject of living altogether out of view is better than to set a high value on it.
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[At] a man's birth, he is flexible and weak. [At] his death, he is firm and strong. [At] the birth of trees and grasses, they are flexible and light. [At] their death, they are dried out and withered. Therefore, those who are firm	Living people are supple and soft. When they're dead they are rigid and hard. Living plants are pliant and green. When they're dead they're unbending and dry. Thus what's rigid and hard accompanies death And what's	THE HARD AND THE SOFT At birth, as in life, mankind is gentle, soft and weak. In death, he becomes hard and rigid. All creatures and All Things - While alive and growing are soft and supple. When dead, become withered, tough, brittle and dry. Hard, rigid, withered,	When people are born, they are soft and yielding. When people die, they are stiff and unyielding. Ten-thousand things (everything) like grass and trees, when they are born, they are soft and supple. When	Man at his birth is supple and weak: at his death, firm and strong.(so it is with) all things. Trees and plants, in their early growth, are soft and brittle; at their death, dry and withered. Thus it is that firmness and strength are the concomitants of death; softness and weakness, the concomitants of life.
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and strong are followers of death. Those who are flexible and weak are disciples of life. Therefore The strong army is necessarily destroyed. The strong tree necessarily snaps. The strong and large occupy the inferior position. The flexible and weak occupy the superior position.	pliant and soft accompanies life. If a soldier's too strong, he will suffer defeat. If a tree is too hard it will be cut down. The strong and big go down. The soft and weak go high.	tough, brittle and dry, Being companions of death - Gentle, soft, weak and supple are Companions of life. Thus - The hard weapon will be broken. The hardwood tree will be cut down. The hard and the mighty are cast down. The soft and the weak are exalted.	they die, they are rigid and dry. Stiffness and unyielding are death's companions. Softness and yielding are life's companions. Unyielding armies will not win. Unyielding trees become weapons. Great strength dwells below. Weakness dwells above.	Hence he who (relies on) the strength of his force does not conquer; and a tree which is strong will fill the outstretched arms, (and thereby invites the feller.) Therefore the place of what is firm and strong is below, and that of what is soft and weak is above.
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The Way of Heaven—its similarity to stretching a bow? That which is high—[it] pulls it down. That which is low—[it] lifts it up. That which has excess—[it] reduces it. That which is lacking—[it] adds to it. The Way of Heaven Takes away [where] there is excess And adds to [where there is] lack. The way of people Necessarily different	The Tao of heaven is like the bending of a bow. What is high is brought down. What is low is sent high. What's excessive is reduced. What's insufficient is increased. The Tao of heaven takes from those who have too much And gives to those who are in want. The people's way is not like that. They take from	EQUILIBRIUM As a bow is bent, so bends the way of nature. That at the top, Bent downward toward the center. That at the bottom, Bent upward toward the center. The string - If too long, is shortened, If too short, is lengthened. The Tao of nature strives for equilibrium.	Heaven's Tao is similar to drawing a bow. A bow joins the high that is brought down, with the low that is lifted up. Surplus decreases. Deficiency is supplemented. Heaven's Tao reduces a surplus and replenishes a deficiency. Humanity's Tao is not like the following: There is not enough, therefore give to those who	May not the Way (or Tao) of Heaven be compared to the (method of) bending a bow? The (part of the bow) which was high is brought low, and what was low is raised up. (So Heaven) diminishes where there is superabundance, and supplements where there is deficiency. It is the Way of Heaven to diminish superabundance, and supplements where there is deficiency. It is the Way of Heaven to diminish superabundance, and to supplement deficiency.
Takes away [where there is] lack In order to offer to [that which] has excess. Who can have surplus by means of offering [it] to the world? Only those who have the Tao. Therefore, the sages Act but do not presume Achieve goals but do not dwell [on them]. They do not desire to be seen as praiseworthy or despicable.	those who are in want And give to those who have too much. Yet who is able to have enough to give it to the world? Only the one who has Tao. Therefore the sage toils but expects no praise. He does his work but does not dwell on it. He does not wish to make a display of his merit.	is reduced. That which is deficient is supplemented. Mankind, on the other hand, will often - Further reduce what is deficient, Supplement that which is abundant. The Sage alone - Having abundance, offers it to the world. Works quietly without arousing attention. Acts without claiming recognition or reward.	have a lot. Who is able to have abundance and serve Heaven below (the sacred body)? Only those who have the Tao. The sage does their work and does not expect a reward. They complete their work and do not stop. They do not have deep-seated desires to show that their actions exceed others'.	It is not so with the way of man. He takes away from those who have not enough to add to his own superabundance. Who can take his own superabundance and therewith serve all under heaven? Only he who is in possession of the Tao! Therefore the (ruling) sage acts without claiming the results as his; he achieves his merit and does not rest (arrogantly) in it: - he does not wish to display his superiority.

There is nothing in the world as flexible and weak as water. And [among] those things that work at the firm and the strong There is nothing that can surpass it [in this] For it is without means [for the hard and strong] to alter it. The victory of the weak over the strong The victory of the flexible over the firm	There is nothing in the world softer than water. And there's nothing weaker. Yet for attacking the hard and strong There is nothing better. There is no substitute for it. What is weak defeats what's strong. What is soft defeats what's hard. This is something known	THE CHARACTER OF WATER Flowing water - Being softer and more yielding than all else under the heavens, Has no equal in attacking and prevailing against that which is hard and resistant. The supple, weak and yielding, thereby, Conquer the rigid, strong and resistant. While this is known by all mankind,	Heaven below (the sacred body) is not as soft and yielding as water, yet can take on the rigid and violent. Without its (the sacred body's) ability to overcome the rigid and the violent, it is nothing. It replaces violence with gentleness. It overcomes violence. Tenderly it overcomes the unyielding. Without knowing	There is nothing in the world more soft and weak than water, and yet for attacking things that are firm and strong there is nothing that can take precedence of it; -for there is nothing (so effectual) for which it can be changed.
There are none in the world who do not know [of these]. None who cannot practice [them]. Therefore do the sages say: "Accepting the filth of the kingdom— This is called taking charge of the gods of soil and the gods of grain. To accept the banes of the kingdom— This is to become the ruler of the world." Correct sayings seem contradictory.	to all. Yet this knowledge is used by none. That's why the sage declares: "If you bear the country's dishonor You become the lord of its shrines. If you bear the country's misfortune You become the king of the world." True words seem to sound wrong.	Few are they who can flow in this manner. Thus the Sage - By accepting the disgrace and humiliation of the community, Is called a leader in the community. By receiving the burdens and misfortunes of the nation, Becomes a ruler of the nation. Surely these words, while paradoxical, are true.	this, no one in Heaven below can progress. The sages speak of guarding the community: Dishonor comes from making sacrifices to the gods. Preserve the community, not its omens. It is correct to speak of Heaven below as what connects Heaven, Humanity and Earth. The words of the person who sacrifices backfire.	Every one in the world knows that the soft overcomes the hard, and the weak the strong, but no one is able to carry it out in practice. Therefore a sage has said 'He who accepts his state's reproach, Is altars' lord; To him who bears men's direful woes They all the name of King accord.' Words that are strictly true seem to be paradoxical.

[After] pacifying great hatred Surely there exists remaining resentment. How can [this] be considered good? Therefore, the sages keep the left side [of an] agreement And do not demand	When great enemies settle their quarrel Some of their enmity will linger on. Is there a way to set things right? The sage abides by the agreement And does not	OF OBLIGATIONS AND CLAIMS At the conclusion of a serious dispute, It is rare that some resentment not remain behind. To restore harmony, the Sage, Keeping to the letter of the agreement with regard to his own obligations, Never compels the other to	If you agree with great hatred surely there will be a surplus of hatred. How are you then able to act with virtue? The sage holds the left side of the contract* and does not make claims on the people. They have the action of the	When a reconciliation is effected (between two parties) after a greatanimosity, there is sure to be a grudge remaining (in the mind of the onewho was wrong). And how can this be beneficial (to the other)? Therefore(to guard against this), the sage keeps the left-hand portion of the recordof the engagement, and does not insist on the (speedy) fulfillment of itby the other party.
[the right side] from people. Having virtue, [one] manages an agreement. Lacking virtue, [one] manages to deprive. The Heavenly Tao is not personal. [It] always give[s] kindly to people.	seek to assign blame. People of virtue meet their obligations. Those without virtue exact their claims. The Tao of heaven does not take sides. Yet it always stays with the good.	fulfill his responsibilities. Having Te, one would attend to obligations. Without Te, one would press claims. While it is the nature of Tao to be free of partiality, Holding to the essence of the Tao, The truly virtuous find the Tao abiding within.	soul which takes charge of their contract. Without the action of the soul the contract would be unfulfilled. The heaven's Tao is not personal. It is eternally on the side of the person's goodness. * The left side was the position below or the position of debtor.	(So), he who has the attributes (of the Tao) regards(only) the conditions of the engagement, while he who has not those attributesregards only the conditions favourable to himself. In the Way of Heaven,there is no partiality of love; it is always on the side of the good man.

The small kingdom [with] few people: Causes them to have the equipment of ten noblemen but not to use it. Causes the people to give weight to death and not to move far away. Though having boats and carriages, they've no place to ride them. Though having armor and weapons, they've no place to exhibit them. Causes the	If a country is small its people are few. Having tools in abundance, they're unwilling to use them. Mindful of death, they do not venture far. Having wagons and boats, they do not ride in them. Having weapons and shields, they keep them out of sight. To keep records they've returned to	THE IDEAL STATE A small, intimate, sparsely populated community, Was thought by its ruler to be an ideal easily controlled state. Labor saving devices and life's necessities, Existing in abundance, Were not used or needed. Being satisfied with the quality of life, There was no need to search for better things. Having boats and carriages, There appeared no use for them. Having arms and weapons, There was no occasion for their employment.	A petty country diminishes the people. They possess ten times a hundred workers and yet do not use them. They control the people by giving weight to death and the people do not move away. Rather than owning boats and carriages, be free of a reason to ride in them. Rather than being in armies and displaying weapons, be free without a reason for them. Thus the	In a little state with a small population, I would so order it, that, though there were individuals with the abilities of ten or a hundred men, there would be no employment of them; I would make the people, while looking on death as a grievous thing, yet not remove elsewhere (to avoid it). Though they had boats and carriages, they should have no occasion to ride in them; though they had buff coats and sharp weapons, they should have no occasion to don or use them.
people to return to knotting rope and using it. Sweetens their meals Beautifies their clothes Pacifies their abodes Gladdens [them in] their customs. The neighboring kingdoms see each other in the distance Hearing the sounds of each other's chickens and dogs. The people arrive at old age [and eventually] die	using knotted cords. They relish their food, Delight in their clothes, Find peace in their homes, And joy in their plain way of life. Though the neighboring country is within sight, And its roosters and dogs can be heard, People live, grow old and die Without ever leaving to visit their neighbors.	simple, The commerce of the community required no greater means than knotted cords to ease the accounting of transactions. Thus the people were: - Satisfied with their food. - Content with their clothing. - Comfortable with their shelter. - Happy with their customs and traditions. Even though neighboring communities were within sight and earshot of cocks and barking dogs, They would leave each other in peace while they would grow old and die.	people return to being continuously united and employed. They will enjoy their food. They will delight in their clothes. They will be content with their homes. They will enjoy their everyday lives. Neighboring communities visit and help each other. Both will listen together to the calls of each others' dogs and roosters. At its height the people grow old and die without a reason to inspect each other.	I would make the people return to the use of knotted cords (instead of the written characters). They should think their (coarse) food sweet: their (plain) clothes beautiful; their (poor) dwellings places of rest; and their common (simple) ways sources of enjoyment. There should be a neighboring state within sight, and the voices of the fowls and dogs should be heard all the way from it to us, but I would make the people to old age, even to death, not have any intercourse with it.

Sincere speech is not pleasing.

Pleasing speech is not sincere.

Those who are good do not argue.

Those who argue are not good.

Those who understand are not broadly learned.

Those who are broadly learned do not understand.

The sages do not accumulate.

Already, by means of doing for people

They have more and more for

True words are not beautiful.

Beautiful words are not true.

Good people do not argue.

Those who argue are not good.

Those who know are not learned.

The learned do not know.

The sage accumulates nothing.

The more he does for

IN CONCLUSION

Truthful words are rarely pleasant and fine sounding.

Pleasant and fine sounding words are rarely truthful.

The good need not prove by argument.

To prove by argument is rarely good.

True wisdom rarely springs from learning.

Learning rarely is indicative of true wisdom.

The sage need never hoard.

Doing more for others, The more he gains.

Giving more to others, The greater is his abundance.

The Tao of heaven benefits without injury or

Believing in words is not good.

Good words are not believed.

Skillful people do not dispute.

Those who dispute are not skillful.

Knowing it is not the same as wide learning.*

Wide learning is not the same as knowing.

The sage does

Sincere words are not fine; fine words are not sincere. Those who are skilled (in the Tao) do not dispute (about it); the disputatious are not skilled in it. Those who know (the Tao) are not extensively learned; the extensively learned do not know it.

themselves.

Already, by means of giving to people

They have more and more—too much—for themselves.

The Way of Heaven is to benefit and not to harm.

The Way of sages is to do but not to struggle.

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others, the more he has.

The more he gives to others, the more he receives.

The Tao of heaven is to benefit, not harm.

The Tao of the sage is to act for others, not to contend with them.

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harm.

The Tao of the Sage accomplishes without striving or contention.

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not hoard.

Because they work for others, they have more.

Having shared with people, they have abundance.

Heaven's Tao is sharp, and does not injure.

The sage's Tao becomes, and does not compete.

* Wide learning=Metabolizing experiences in the body

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The sage does not accumulate (for himself). The more that he expends for others, the more does he possess of his own; the more that he gives to others, the more does he have himself. With all the sharpness of the Way of Heaven, it injures not; with all the doing in the way of the sage he does not strive.

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